Character Qualities

Character Qualities teaching materials adapted for youth instruction from the source course by Stephen Wineka.

Cumulative teacher and student editions covering the Character Qualities course.

Full teaching files

quiz for character qualities 1	*2 pages*
Edge youth Character Qualities - student Copy WEEK 9 final copy	*25 pages*
Edge youth Character Qualities - teacher Copy WEEK 9 final copy	*25 pages*

Teacher and student editions are components of this one portfolio entry.

1. **According to the notes, what is the primary reason "blameless" is the first quality listed for a pastor and deacon?**

A) It ensures popularity with the congregation.

B) It is the easiest character quality to maintain.

C) It is the foundation for all other character qualities and part of God's great plan for your life.

D) It relates only to public reputation.

2. **Why is it important for a believer to be blameless before others according to the study?**

A) So that accusations can never be made.

B) So that when accusations arise, they do not stick.

C) To avoid church discipline.

D) To never have to apologize for mistakes.

3. **How should single people apply the quality of being "the husband of one wife" to their lives according to the notes?**

A) By focusing on finding a spouse quickly.

B) By applying it to their spiritual relationship with Jesus Christ.

C) By dating multiple people to learn what they like.

D) By ignoring this quality until marriage.

4. **"Vigilant" encompasses which of the following according to the notes?**

A) Being aware of physical dangers only.

B) Being watchful for temptation, spiritual dangers, and guarding over others.

C) Only praying when trouble arises.

D) Never trusting anyone around you.

5. **According to the study, how are "sober" and "vigilant" connected?**

A) They are unrelated qualities.

B) Both require you to avoid all forms of entertainment.

C) Both involve self-control and being alert to spiritual dangers.

D) Both emphasize isolation from others.

6. **What practical application is given for being "grave"?**

A) Always being quiet and reserved.

B) Taking serious things seriously, such as sin, salvation, and personal holiness.

C) Ignoring lighthearted situations.

D) Refusing to smile or laugh in public.

7. **Why is "hospitality" important toward non-believers, according to the study?**

A) To gain respect and popularity in the community.

B) It reflects God's heart for loving strangers and can be a means to share the gospel.

C) To increase attendance at church events.

D) To fulfill social obligations.

8. **What is required to be "apt to teach" beyond just knowing Scripture?**

A) Natural speaking ability.

B) A desire to be noticed by others.

C) Learning the Word, applying it personally, and being willing to teach others what you have been taught.

D) Memorizing large portions of the Bible.

9. **Why is being “doubletongued” dangerous according to the notes?**

A) It leads to public embarrassment.

B) It is a form of lying that can kill a ministry and destroy relationships.

C) It makes conversations confusing.

D) It results in a bad reputation only among friends.

10. **What is the biblical reasoning against being “greedy of filthy lucre”?**

A) Money should never be pursued for any reason.

B) It is the love of money and improper methods of gain that corrupt character and ministry.

C) Only rich people are affected by this issue.

D) The Bible says to avoid earning any wealth.

11. **How is “patience” developed according to the notes?**

A) By avoiding all stressful situations.

B) By enduring temptations, trials, and trusting God through adversity.

C) Through relaxation techniques.

D) By living in isolation.

12. **What is the primary caution behind the instruction to be “not a brawler”?**

A) To never stand up for oneself.

B) Constant confrontation and fighting, whether verbal or physical, disqualifies one from ministry.

C) To avoid heated debates in public.

D) To stay away from athletic competitions.

13. **Why must a leader in the church “not be a novice”?**

A) Novices are too young to serve.

B) Without experience, they risk being lifted up with pride and falling into the condemnation of the devil.

C) They cannot be trusted with money.

D) They won’t be able to preach effectively.

14. **Why is having “a good report to them which are without” important?**

A) It prevents any criticism from the world.

B) To maintain personal pride in public settings.

C) So that the lost world has fewer reasons to criticize Christianity and believers can be more effective witnesses.

D) To receive community awards.

15. **What does it mean to be “faithful in all things” according to the notes?**

A) Being perfect in every area of life.

B) Being full of faith and consistently trustworthy in all responsibilities.

C) Attending every church service.

D) Memorizing the entire Bible.

The Character Qualities of a Man or Woman of God

Week 1

Introduction

During this study we will examine 27 character qualities of a man or woman of God. It is important for us to understand that even though these character qualities are found in the texts dealing with the qualifications for a Pastor and Deacon, they are also the standard for every believer (both men and women).

- Acts 6:3; Acts 14:23; Titus 1:5

What are the character qualities?

- A multitude of evident personal character qualities - 1 Timothy 3:1-13; Titus 1:5-9
- The qualities are as follows:

1. Blameless
2. The husband of one wife
3. Vigilant
4. Sober
5. Grave
6. Of good behavior
7. Given to hospitality
8. Apt to teach
9. Not given to wine
10. Not doubletongued
11. No striker
12. Not greedy of filthy lucre
13. Patient
14. Not a brawler
15. Not slanderers
16. Not covetous
17. Ruleth well his own house
18. Not a novice
19. A good report to them which are without
20. Faithful in all things
21. Not self-willed
22. Not soon angry
23. A lover of good men
24. Just
25. Holy
26. Temperate
27. Holding fast the faithful word

**DURING THIS CLASS WE WILL BE MOVING THROUGH A LOT IN A SHORT TIME, THE KEY TO HELPING WITH THIS AND FOR YOU TO WALK AWAY WITH SOMETHING EACH WEEK IS THIS: MARK DOWN WITH A STAR/NOTES, 3 THINGS ON THE NOTES EACH WEEK THAT STAND OUT TO YOU THAT YOU NEED TO WORK ON. NO MORE THAN THIS, AND NO LESS!

#1 - Blameless

1 Timothy 3:2, 10 - 2 A bishop then must be **blameless**, the husband of one wife, vigilant, sober, of good behaviour, given to hospitality, apt to teach; …10 And let these also first be proved; then let them use the office of a deacon, being found **blameless**.

Titus 1:6-7 - 6 If any be **blameless**, the husband of one wife, having faithful children not accused of riot or unruly. 7 For a bishop must be **blameless**, as the steward of God; not selfwilled, not soon angry, not given to wine, no striker, not given to filthy lucre.

Definition of "Blameless":	*"free from blame or the just imputation of fault, **NOT** sinless or un-accused"*

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1st Mention:	Genesis 44:10 - "And he said, Now also let it be according unto your words: he with whom it is found shall be my servant; and ye shall be blameless."

Having a blameless character means that others are not able to justly accuse you of being wrong or doing wrong. When accusations are thrown, they will not stick. Since no one is perfect, we will all likely violate this character quality, along with the others we will be studying. When this happens in our life and we are aware of it, we need to accept personal responsibility, confess our sin, deal with the consequences, and move forward with Christ!

Blameless is the most important character quality…

- It is the first quality listed in 1 Timothy 3:2, and it is mentioned twice in Titus 1:6-7
- It is the standard for all believers - Phil. 2:13-15; 1 Thess. 5:23; 2 Pt. 3:14; 1 Jn. 3:3
- It is the foundation for all the other character qualities and it is part of Gods great plan for your life– Eph. 1:4
- Your behavior can cause your MINISTRY to be blamed; therefore we must remain blameless- 2 Cor. 6:3

As followers of the Jesus Christ, we ought to be blameless before the Lord, other believers, and the world…

- 1 Cor. 10:31-32; 11:1; 2 Cor. 1:12; 6:3; Phil. 1:10; 3:17; 1 Tim. 5:14; 6:1; Tts. 2:5; 2 Sam. 12:14; 1 Pt. 2:21-23
  - When you follow the Lord, you can and will be blamed for many things, especially as a leader. What you need to do is make sure that it is not able to stick because you are blameless. Sometimes this means simply making a wrong doing, right; or it can mean to simply stay out of situations where you can be blamed.
  - We all WILL make mistakes, misspeak, and let others down; they key is humility to make it right always so that you are blameless. This is a non-negotiable in ministry. If you cannot do this then you will not be fruitful in your ministry.

#2 - The husband of one wife

1 Timothy 3:2 - A bishop then must be blameless, **the husband of one wife**, vigilant, sober, of good behaviour, given to hospitality, apt to teach;

Titus 1:6 - If any be blameless, **the husband of one wife**, having faithful children not accused of riot or unruly.

The husband of one wife = "Complete and total devotion to one mate; a one-woman man"

(Since nobody in here is married yet, apply these to your spiritual husband, Jesus Christ)

- ✓ Faithful with eyes - Job 31:1
- ✓ Faithful with mind - 2 Cor. 11:2-3
- ✓ Faithful with heart - Dan. 1:8; Matt. 15:18-19

Single people need to develop this area properly

- Some things are reserved for marriage only - Heb. 13:4; Gen. 1:27-28; 2:21, 24
- Singleness is a high calling - 1 Cor. 7:17-24; Phil 4:11; Heb. 13:5
- The advantages of singleness - 1 Cor. 7:32-45; Matt. 13:22
- Be pure - 1 Cor. 6:15-20; Rom. 6:12-13; 1 Pt. 2:11; Eph. 5:3

- Be someone who is FAITHFUL: to God now, to your spouse later. This can even start now with your dating/engagement time of life.
- Someone who is a "flirt" is not a good person to pursue. They are already showing signs of not being a "one woman kind of man" or a "one man kind of woman".

#3 - Vigilant

1 Timothy 3:2 - A bishop then must be blameless, the husband of one wife, **vigilant**, sober, of good behaviour, given to hospitality, apt to teach;

Vigilant = "to watch; to keep watch; stay awake; alert and watchful especially to danger; to be ready; surveillance; prepared; focused (*The guard was on an all-night vigil*)"

- ✓ Watchful is a good synonym

  Genesis 2:15 - "And the LORD God took the man, and put him into the garden of Eden to dress it and *to keep it*."

Watchful for yourself

- ✓ Watch and pray concerning areas of fleshly temptation/personal weakness - Matt. 26:38-41; 1 Cor. 10:12-13

Watchful for those whom God has given you

- ✓ Watch to feed - Acts 20:28; 1 Pt. 5:2-3
- ✓ Watch for wolves from without - Acts 20:29; 2 Pt. 2:1
- ✓ Watch for wolves from within - Acts 20:30-31; Ezek. 34:1-4
- ✓ Watch in prayer for all the saints - Eph. 6:18; 1:15-16
- ✓ Watch and pray for open doors - Col. 4:2-4; Eph. 6:19
- ✓ Watch for the tendency to be pulled away from preaching of the word - 2 Tim. 4:1-5; Jer. 5:31; Lk. 6:26; 2 Pt. 2:1-3
  - Is your life in a place that you are able to help others?
  - Who have you helped in this ministry? How?
  - How is your prayer life for this ministry?

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Week 2

#4 - Sober

1 Timothy 3:2, 11 - 2 A bishop then must be blameless, the husband of one wife, vigilant, **sober**, of good behaviour, given to hospitality, apt to teach; …11 Even so must their wives be grave, not slanderers, **sober**, faithful in all things.

Titus 1:8 - But a lover of hospitality, a lover of good men, **sober**, just, holy, temperate;

Sober = "to be sensible; to have control of your mind, emotions, senses and impulses in all circumstances"

- This is especially true of young people (young men are warned of this as we will see later). You have a zeal and fire in you that helps BUT can hinder you if you are not careful

- Sober and vigilant (watchful) are closely related - 1 Tim. 3:2
  - ✓ 1 Pt. 1:13 - "…gird up the loins of your mind, be sober…"
  - ✓ Phil. 4:5 - "Let your moderation be known to all men…"
  - ✓ 1 Cor. 9:25 - "…temperate in all things…"
- Important questions to ask yourself…
  1. What are the things that take control of my **mind**?- Titus 2:6
  2. What are the things that take control of my **emotions**?- Daniel 1:8; Ephesians 5:26
     - These verses show us that the world is trying to bring you "under the influence", maybe using things like "influencers" and social media. To think, believe, and act differently than you know to when you are "sober"
     - It is great to have zeal, but if you are not sober minded and you are brought under the influence of something else then you will make unwise choices that have lasting effects, BUT YOU WONT KNOW IT IN THE MOMENT
     - Interestingly enough, water is what is used to "sober" people up, and we see in Ephesians 5:26 that this water for us, is the word of God

#5 - Grave

1 Timothy 3:4, 8, 11 - 4 One that ruleth well his own house, having his children in subjection with all **gravity**; …8 Likewise must the deacons be **grave**, not doubletongued, not given to much wine, not greedy of filthy lucre; …11 Even so must their wives be **grave**, not slanderers, sober, faithful in all things.

Grave = "Something momentous, weighty, influential, of great importance; to be serious, solemn, sober"

- ✓ It means to take things that are serious seriously
  - There is a time for joking and fun, BUT there are times and things that require full attention and all seriousness.
- ✓ Do you take seriously:
  - Your sin?- Galatians 6:7-8
  - The salvation of those around you?- Rev. 20:15
  - The growth of this ministry?
  - The word of God?- John 1:1

- Personal holiness?- 1 Thess. 4:3-4
- Prayer?- Luke 22:44
- Etc..

#6 - Of good behaviour

1 Timothy 3:2 - A bishop then must be blameless, the husband of one wife, vigilant, sober, **of good behaviour**, given to hospitality, apt to teach;

Of good behaviour = "Orderly; well-arranged"- 1 Sam. 18:14

*9/20 mentions of "behave" in the Bible are talking about how David "behaved" himself

Good behaviour has to do with specific areas:

- ✓ Orderly in our daily life - 1 Thess. 2:10; 2 Cor. 4:2
- ✓ Orderly in our work ethic - 2 Thess. 3:6-11; 1 Pt. 5:2-3

It is becoming of the gospel for us to be of good behaviour:

Note: We are His ambassadors (ambassadors of good will) - 2 Cor. 5:20

#7 - Given to hospitality

1 Timothy 3:2 - A bishop then must be blameless, the husband of one wife, vigilant, sober, of good behaviour, **given to hospitality**, apt to teach;

Titus 1:8 - But **a lover of hospitality**, a lover of good men, sober, just, holy, temperate;

Given to hospitality = "Giving; Friendly; Being sensitive to the needs of others; Developed from the word hospital…to care for; A friendly treatment of guests and strangers."

Hospitable toward:

- Believers
  - Gal. 6:10 - "…especially unto them who are of the household of faith."
  - 1 Jn. 3:17 - "But whoso hath this world's good, and seeth his brother hath need…"
- Non-Believers
  - Hospitality tested:
    - ✓ Heb. 13:2 - "Be not forgetful to entertain strangers…" (Entertain strangers = Hospitality!)
  - Strangers typified:
    - ✓ Lev. 19:34 - "…for ye were strangers in the land of Egypt:"

      * Loving strangers is the heart of God - Deut. 10:17-19; Lev. 19:34

Note: How we respond to the lost is a great indicator of our love for God!

Hospitality is the willingness to let God use whatever he has given you to help others…

- ✓ What are ways in which you can exercise hospitality to believers?
- ✓ What are ways in which you can exercise hospitality to non-believers?

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#8 - Apt to teach

1 Timothy 3:2 - A bishop then must be blameless, the husband of one wife, vigilant, sober, of good behaviour, given to hospitality, **apt to teach**;

Titus 1:9 - Holding fast the faithful word as he hath been taught, that he may be able by sound doctrine both to **exhort and to convince the gainsayers**.

This is a learned character quality for every child of God to develop (Some are gifted to teach, this goes beyond one's ability to learn - Eph. 4:8, 11)

The first mention:

- Exodus 4:10-12 - **Availability**, not ability, is the key
  - Are you available to open your mouth and "teach" the Bible to those who you interact with? Are you willing?

This also means we need to be investing in " learning" the word, so that we can be ready to "teach" it

You can only teach what you have been taught - 2 Tim. 2:2; 2 Tim. 2:15; 1 Tim. 4:16

- ✓ What kind of learner am I?
- ✓ How well do I pay attention?
- ✓ How well do I listen to others?
- ✓ How is my Bible study time?
- ✓ Do I learn from circumstances of life easily?
- ✓ Do I seek out opportunities to learn from/follow others who I know can help me learn even more?

- You are at a time in life where you can/should be building a large foundation of your learning the Bible. You have the time, resources, lower level of responsibility, and God tells us that it should be one of the focuses of your age (1 Jn. 2:14)

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Week 3

#9 - Not given to wine

1 Timothy 3:3, 8 - 3 **Not given to wine**, no striker, not greedy of filthy lucre; but patient, not a brawler, not covetous; … 8 Likewise must the deacons be grave, not doubletongued, **not given to much wine**, not greedy of filthy lucre;

Titus 1:7 - For a bishop must be blameless, as the steward of God; not selfwilled, not soon angry, **not given to wine**, no striker, not given to filthy lucre;

The word of God condemns drunkenness:

- ✓ Eph. 5:18 - "And be not drunk with wine…"
- ✓ 1 Pt. 4:2-3 - "…the time past of our life…when we walked in…excess of wine…"
- ✓ Prov. 20:1 - "Wine is a mocker, strong drink is raging: and whoever is deceived thereby is not wise."
- ✓ Prov. 23:29-35 - "…it biteth like a serpent…"

The wise man or woman avoids it:

- ✓ Lev. 10:9 - No alcohol permitted while serving in the capacity of a priest
- ✓ Prov. 31:4 - Kings and priests were to avoid strong drink - 1 Pt. 2:5, 9; Rev. 1:6; 5:10

The bible very carefully and specifically defines our attitude toward alcohol:

- ✓ Allowances were only for medicinal purposes - 1 Tim. 5:23
- ✓ Interpreting our culture:
  - → The #1 killer of teenagers is alcohol related auto accidents
  - → The #1 factor in domestic violence is alcohol
  - → A major component of immorality is intoxication

Note: You can justify anything if you really want to. The Bible does NOT make provisions for us to drink socially. Total abstinence is the best policy regarding alcohol consumption. However, if you really want to violate God's word, God will let you fool yourself - Ezek. 14:1-4, 9; Matt. 13; Jer. 23.

The Bible says that nothing should control our lives but the Holy Spirit… and we can be drunk on many things

- ✓ 1 Co. 6:12; 1 Thess. 5:5-8; Ephesians 5:18

#10 - Not doubletongued

1 Timothy 3:8 - Likewise must the deacons be grave, **not doubletongued**, not given to much wine, not greedy of filthy lucre;

Doubletongued = "double in speech; saying one thing with one and another thing with another; a type of lying"

- ✓ This is the only time this word in used in the Bible
- ✓ See James 1:8; 3:3-12(verse 10 especially)
  - o Our tongue should not be a place where we bless God and yet curse others
  - o This kind of speaking will kill a ministry. Gossip and ill speaking will kill a ministry, friendships, and your personal walk with the Lord. (Jeremiah 9:3,5,,8-9)

- God HATES this kind of behavior (Prov. 6:16-19)

This can be best understood by just reading the scripture…

- ✓ Watch out for flatterers - Ps. 12:1-3; 5:9
- ✓ Watch out for liars - Ps. 50:19; 52:2; Rom. 3:13; Eph. 4:25; James 5:12 (let your yea be yea and your nay be nay)
- ✓ What your mouth should be: a well of life, ministering to others- Prov. 10:11; Eph. 4:29
- ✓ The Bottom Line- A mature Christian who is to lead God's people, cannot and will not participate in this kind of behavior. It will **kill** your ministry and any chance of growth you have in it.

#11 - No striker

1 Timothy 3:3 - Not given to wine, **no striker**, not greedy of filthy lucre; but patient, not a brawler, not covetous;

Titus 1:7 - For a bishop must be blameless, as the steward of God; not selfwilled, not soon angry, not given to wine, **no striker**, not given to filthy lucre;

No striker = "**Uncontrolled** anger to the point of physical violence"

- ✓ A Striker is someone who is ready to fight

There are striking biblical examples:

- ✓ Genesis 4:8- And Cain talked with Abel his brother: and it came to pass, when they were in the field, that Cain rose up against Abel his brother, and slew him.
  - We can fight or strike our brethren out of jealousy/envy to tear them down
- ✓ Exodus 2:11-12- And it came to pass in those days, when Moses was grown, that he went out unto his brethren, and looked on their burdens: and he spied an Egyptian smiting an Hebrew, one of his brethren. And he looked this way and that way, and when he saw that *there was* no man, he slew the Egyptian, and hid him in the sand.
- ✓ John 18:10-11- Then Simon Peter having a sword drew it, and smote the high priest's servant, and cut off his right ear. The servant's name was Malchus.
  - We can fight/strike others for "just causes". We should not find ourselves in a constant state of fighting and turmoil, it may show we have a "striker" nature.
- ✓ Don't always be so quick to "vindicate yourself" and make yourself have to be "right" in all situations. Seek peace first. Oftentimes this means bearing the **burdens** of others!- Rom. 15:1-3; Luke 6:29
  - It is our "American" posture, but it was NOT the posture of Christ to always "be made right" and make sure they were treated justly and that they were vindicated. Not being a striker means to seek peace and bearing burdens.

Violent abuse can also be verbal

- ✓ A striker usually begins with **verbally** abusing others
- ✓ James 3:1-10 - There is more than one way to hurt someone
- ✓ Proverbs 10:19; 17:27-28 - A man or woman of God should be known for their good words as well as for their good works
  - Don't be QUICK to fight. With your words or your actions. Seek peace (Romans 12:18) when at all possible.

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#12 - Not greedy of filthy lucre

1 Timothy 3:3 - Not given to wine, no striker, **not greedy of filthy lucre**; but patient, not a brawler, not covetous;

Titus 1:7 - For a bishop must be blameless, as the steward of God; not selfwilled, not soon angry, not given to wine, no striker, **not given to filthy lucre**;

Filthy lucre = "Money received through improper methods or motives"

→ A.K.A. - "Dirty Money"

Improper methods:

- Usury (interest): exploiting the crisis of others - Prov. 28:8; Lev. 25:35-37
- Get rich quick schemes - gambling, lottery, high risk investments, etc. - Prov. 13:11

  *Vanity = Empty; with no value - Jer. 17:11; Prov. 28:8, 20, 22
- Bribes and deceit: Deut. 16:19; Prov. 17:23; 1 Sam. 8:1-3

Improper motives:

- Greed – Matthew 6:24
- Desire for power – Matt. 23:12
- Covetousness/Security through materialism – Luke 12:15-21

Money problems are generally not an issue of amount but of attitude

The proper attitude is one of contentment - 1 Tim. 6:6-8; Prov. 30:8-9; Heb. 13:5

✓ A man must be proven in this area before becoming a pastor - 1 Pt. 5:2

The Character Qualities of a Man or Woman of God

Week 4

#13 - Patient

1 Timothy 3:3 - Not given to wine, no striker, not greedy of filthy lucre; but **patient**, not a brawler, not covetous;

Patient = "the ability to bear adversity without complaint"

Patience is a developed character quality.

- It is often associated with being developed in times of temptations and trials- James 1:2-4

→ Patience is learned, but it does not always have to be learned the hard way!

Patience is a requirement for those who minister God's word and lead others

- It is a key quality for God's leaders in ministry -2 Corinthians 6:4-10
  - While we endure these trials and persecutions, God is teaching us patience. It is a quality you can only learn really through time and experience
- Ministry is oftentimes loveless, burdensome, and has little "reward" in it for the minister from those they minister to. Therefore patience in pressing forward is needed- 2 Cor. 12:15
  - Patience in serving, giving, ministering, loving, taking criticism, taking hatred, taking evil speaking, etc.. is needed
- Patience truly is learning to trust God and his word in times of troubles and persecutions. Abraham was a great example- Gen. 12:1-3; 13:15; 15:1-6; 16:1-3; 17:15-19; 21:1-2; Heb 11:8-10,17
  - When God's promises and his "word" start to not make sense because of troubles around us, when we learn to trust his word anyway and wait on him, we are learning patience.

#14 - Not a brawler

1 Timothy 3:3 - Not given to wine, no striker, not greedy of filthy lucre; but patient, **not a brawler**, not covetous;

Brawler = "one who constantly seeks a confrontation; one who enjoys a fight; macho-man; armed for combat"

Some causes of brawling:

✓ Pride - Prov. 13:10

- Do you find yourself in constant contention, drama, or surrounded by issues? You are called to not be a brawler. Pride comes with contention. This is the opposite of the "burden bearing" leader

✓ Proud Debating - 2 Tim. 2:23; Titus 3:9

- Even when dealing with other believers or the lost about things, don't find yourself in constant struggles and "debates". It is a sign of immaturity
- There is nothing wrong with helping others and teaching them (Adam, London) but if you find yourself in contention, pride is somewhere.

Note: Satan started the brawl…"I will be like the most high." - Isaiah 14:13-14

→ Some people just seem to consistently find themselves in conflict

Some questions to ask yourself

- ✓ Do I have a team-mentality, or am I totally independent? - Eph. 4:1-3
- ✓ Do I display a servant's **heart** or self-centeredness? - Phil. 2:1-5
- ✓ Do I seek areas of agreement or disagreement? – Rom. 12:18
- ✓ Do I look for people's strengths or their weaknesses?- Rom. 15:1-2
- ✓ Would my authorities (employer, husband, etc.) say I was submissive in heart? - 2 Pt. 2:10; Jude 8

#15 - Not slanderers

1 Timothy 3:11 - Even so must their wives be grave, **not slanderers**, sober, faithful in all things.

Slanderer = "one that falsely accuses another; acting the part of the devil"

- ✓ Satan is known as the "accuser of our brethren" - Rev. 12:9-10; 2 Tim. 3:3
- ✓ They are false accusations against "brethren" (i.e. soundly saved Christians) because Jesus Christ took our iniquity upon Himself and we received His spotless righteousness in return- Is. 53:4-6; 2 Cor. 5:19-21

→ We are to follow the biblical procedure to restore our brothers/sisters who are overtaken in a fault; not doing so and simply slandering our brothers/sisters will KILL our ministry (Gal. 6:1-2; 2 Sam. 12:1-15; Psalm 51; Matt. 18:15-17)

What this does not mean…

It is not slander to warn others of **false** teachers and heretics. It is not godly to remain silent when false prophets are leading others "off the cliff" of sound doctrine. We still apply Galatians 6:1-2 first, but after that it's time to contend for the faith…loudly if necessary! Eternity is at stake for billions of people! - Titus 1:9-11

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Week 5

#16 - Not covetous

1 Timothy 3:3 - Not given to wine, no striker, not greedy of filthy lucre; but patient, not a brawler, **not covetous**;

Covetousness is defined as idolatry in Colossians 3:5 and Ephesians 5:3-7 - Eager to have more…

- Covetousness declares that God is not enough - Ps. 119:57; 73:25-26

Covetousness is the root cause of much sin

- It is the root of all evil - 1 Tim. 6:10
- It is at the heart of false teaching - 1 Tim. 6:10; 2 Pt. 2:1-3
- It is worthy of separation - 1 Cor. 5:11

Covetousness can become a lifestyle, if it is not controlled

- In relation to material things – Luke 12:15-21
  - The problem with covetousness is that it goes directly against relying upon God, it is directly against the life of FAITH (God is everything, trusting him in everything)
  - God emphasized the sabbath with Israel so much because it was an issue of FAITH and GOD over MONEY and COVETEOUSNESS

Always Remember…

- ✓ A godly man or woman should hate covetousness! - Ex. 18:21 (first mention)
- ✓ The word of God can replace covetousness - Ps. 119:36
  - Think of the KEY of David, THE LOVE OF THE WORD OF GOD; verses the ROOT OF all evil, the LOVE OF MONEY (ye cannot serve God and mammon. You will love one master and hate the other)

#17 - Ruleth well his own house

1 Timothy 3:4-5 - 4 One that **ruleth well his own house**, having his children in subjection with all gravity; 5 (For if a man know not how to **rule his own house**, how shall he take care of the church of God?)

Titus 1:6 - If any be blameless, the husband of one wife, **having faithful children not accused of riot or unruly**.

Ruleth well his own house = "One that rules (or leads) his home in a godly, upright manner, fitting of a true follower of Jesus Christ"

→ Defining this quality is easy: *it means what it says, and says what it means…*

This qualification is a noticeable test for leadership:

-How a man rules his home will be how he rules the church - 1 Tim. 3:5

The principle is clear:

- ✓ My family is the mirror God uses to expose my areas of weakness

How this work in your life today as a youth:

- ✓ Your disciples are a reflection of you (your "spiritual child")- 1 Tim. 1:2; 2 Tim. 2:1
  - o If you have none or you have never led anyone to the Lord, then that is a reflection of you (not an exact but a measurement)
- ✓ Your ministry is a reflection of you
  - o What are you doing for the Lord?
  - o What place do you have in this ministry?
  - o What have you contributed?
  - o Do you have a "ministry" within this "ministry"?
- ✓ Your "fruit" is a reflection of you
  - o The fruit of your life speaks of who you are
  - o What fruit do you have?
  - o How well do you rule what God has entrusted to you (whatever it is)?

#18 - Not a novice

1 Timothy 3:6 - **Not a novice**, lest being lifted up with pride he fall into the condemnation of the devil.

Novice - "Someone in a position of leadership before they are qualified… not experienced"

- → The term refers specifically to a new believer, but carries with it the idea of someone who has not been trained, tested, and proven
- → It is possible to be saved for a long time and still be a novice - 1 Cor. 3:1; Heb. 5:12-13.
- → The issue is one of maturity rather than time

A novice has a special danger of pride. Authority and power can, and usually does, corrupt. Therefore, it is vital that they be tested and proven.

- ✓ Children's ministry - No glory, just responsibility…How does he serve?
- ✓ Adult ministry - Is he diligent? Does he take initiative? Do godly people follow him?
- ✓ Discipleship - How seriously does he approach his commitment to others?
- ✓ General volunteer work - Does he have a submissive heart attitude?

A novice cannot develop these character qualities overnight or by going to school - They must be lived daily…

- ✓ Abraham was 25 years in preparing to be a father
- ✓ Moses was 40 years in preparing to be a deliverer
- ✓ Paul was at least 15 years preparing for his first missionary journey

Note: It is the responsibility of leadership to guard the body of Christ from a novice. Proper testing and training must be part of any local New Testament church structure

#19 - A good report to them which are without

1 Timothy 3:7 - Moreover he must have **a good report of them which are without**; lest he fall into reproach and the snare of the devil.

A good report to them which are without - "Having a good testimony in the **lost** world"

There is no other option…It does matter what the world thinks of us:

→ That we might be able to win them - 1 Cor. 9:19-22; 10:31-33

→ To keep criticism of Christianity at a minimum - 2 Cor. 6:3; 1 Pt. 2:12, 15

→ Note: Remember what the apostle Paul wrote in Philippians 2:14-16…

Test yourself:

- ✓ What is my testimony in the lost world?
- ✓ Is there truth in the lost world's criticism of me?
- ✓ Is it my beliefs or my attitude that people reject?
- ✓ Would my financial report allow me to witness to an employee at my bank?
- ✓ If someone referenced you in a conversation, would that person's ability to be a witness be helped or hindered?

Caution: We are at odds with the lost world because of the word of God and the testimony of Jesus. We will be criticized even when we have not done anything wrong. Give other believers the benefit of the doubt when hearing criticisms concerning them. Keep this in mind when attacks focus on our personalities and characters. Remember, we will suffer for this testimony, so do not expect to get an award from the lost world for witnessing to them.

A great example:

- Timothy- Acts 16:1-3

#20 - Faithful in all things

1 Timothy 3:11 - Even so must their wives be grave, not slanderers, sober, **faithful in all things**.

Faithful in all things - "faithful in everything; worthy of trust in all things"

- ✓ This is also specifically addressed to wives of deacons. Men (or in this case deacons) obviously should also be faithful in all things. In fact, the husbands should be spiritually teaching and leading their wives in this area- 1 Cor. 14:34-35; 1 Tim. 2:11-14; Eph. 5:22-24

Faithful can be broken down as someone who is "full of faith"; is this descriptive of your life?

- ✓ Hebrews 11- Do you trust God/his word even when the world tells you it is crazy?
- ✓ Are you someone that can be counted on? By God and other people?- Luke 16:10

#21 - Not self-willed

Titus 1:7 - For a bishop must be blameless, as the steward of God; **not selfwilled**, not soon angry, not given to wine, no striker, not given to filthy lucre;

Self-Willed = "Not yielding to the wishes of others; stubborn; obstinate; willful adherence to one's own desires or ideas; controlled by one's own will; someone full of self (pride); one who only wants things done their way"

Note: This is especially prevalent in false teachers - 2 Pt. 2:10; Jude 8

→ Therefore, someone who is not self-willed wants things done God's way…



The Character Qualities of a Man or Woman of God

When we are not self-willed we will tend to give God the glory rather than ourselves:

- He should have the pre-eminence - Col. 1:18; 3 Jn. 9
- HIS will, not OUR will, should be our focus- Mt. 26:39, 42
    - This is all about the will of God, seeking God and his kingdom, his glory first. NOT our plans, our will, our thoughts.
    - We can have and express our thoughts to God, but we must be willing to submit, and not be selfwilled.

Personal evaluation:

- ✓ Would the people in my home, office, or sphere of influence say that I am self-willed?
- ✓ Does everything usually end up going my way?
- ✓ Do people seem to adjust to or work around my personality?
- ✓ Am I a quitter (do I give up easily)?
- ✓ Am I a good follower?

The Character Qualities of a Man or Woman of God

WEEK 6

#22 - Not soon angry

Titus 1:7 - For a bishop must be blameless, as the steward of God; not selfwilled, **not soon angry**, not given to wine, no striker, not given to filthy lucre;

Not soon angry = "A person who is seldom angry; a person who is not angered easily; a person who, when angry for a just cause, is not angry for long (Jas. 1:19)

Anger is not always sin… proper, biblical anger exists - Mk. 3:5; Ps. 7:11

- Matthew 5:22 - Without a cause… there must be a time when there is a cause
- Ephesians 4:26-27 - Be ye angry and sin not… there must be a sinless anger

Anger is sin when:

- When it is kept in and not dealt with - Eph. 4:26-27
  - ✓ If we do not deal with anger we give the Devil a foot-hold
- When it seeks revenge - Rom. 12:19-21
  - ✓ Taking vengeance is taking the position of God
  - ✓ It means I have been overcome
- When it is for selfish reasons - Gen. 4:1-8; Jonah 4:1; Lk. 15:28
  - ✓ Would it bother me as bad if this was done to someone else?

Note: Jesus' anger was always in regard to the violation of God's righteousness or God's people - Matt. 21:12-13; Mk. 3:1-5

Anger is caused by:

- Pride: When my rights have been violated - Jas. 4:1
  - ✓ We cannot consider ourselves spirit controlled when bitterness remains a part of our lives - Jas. 3:13-18
- Insecurity/Envy: A result from feeling threatened in position or relationships - 1 Sam. 18:6-9
    - o Saul Jealous over David and the people reverencing David and his victories
  - ✓ How do I respond to those who question my authority?
  - ✓ Do I become frustrated when my routines are interrupted?
  - ✓ How do I react when my control is lost?
- Foolishness: Anger is evidence of lack of wisdom - Prov. 12:16; 27:3; Eccl. 7:9
- Anger is a secondary emotion: it is always caused by something else: the root of the problem is **something else**

Anger results in:

- Vulnerability: Spiritual sickness…You become easily controlled by the enemy and predictable - Prov. 25:28; 16:32
  - ✓ Open to demonic influence: Eph. 4:26-27
      - o Neither give place to the devil

Anger is to be dealt with biblically:

- ✓ **Yield your rights to God…you are His** - 1 Cor. 6:19-20; **Learn to rest in him** - Ps. 37:7-8; **Use a soft answer** - Prov. 15:1; **Walk in the spirit** - Gal. 5:16-25; **Pass over faults…remember, he passed over our faults** - Prov. 12:16; 19:11; **Listen twice as much as you speak** - Jas. 1:20; 3:2-10; **Saturate your mind with scripture dealing with anger** - Ps. 119:9-11

#23 - A lover of good men

Titus 1:8 - But a lover of hospitality, **a lover of good men**, sober, just, holy, temperate;

A Good Man = "An upright and **perfect** man" (Prov. 2:20-21)

→ Although we are all sinners and are careful not to define ourselves as good, the Bible clearly tells us to be lovers of good men. This obviously means there must be good, godly men. (Not good in and of ourselves…)

Additional biblical credentials of a good man:

- ✓ Saved men - Matthew 13:38
- ✓ Fruit-bearing men - Matthew 13:23; 7:15-20
- ✓ Stable men - Psalm 37:23-24
- ✓ Benevolent and honest men - Psalm 112:5
  - o Who you are surrounded by WILL EFFECT YOU. It is a reflection of you. It says a lot about you. Be careful of who you are surrounded by. Make sure they are good men/women according to the BIBLE!

Some practical things that identify good men:

- ✓ A good man lives by faith - Romans 4, Hebrews 11
- ✓ A good man is hated by evil and wicked men - Prov. 29:27
- ✓ A good man avoids evil - Prov. 16:17
- ✓ A good man desires to be sharpened by his friends - Prov. 27:17
  - → *A good man is not intimidated, but rather challenged, by the goodness of others*
- ✓ A good man will find encouragement in his friend's counsel - Prov. 27:9
  - → *Our intimate friendships reveal much about our character*

WEEK 7

#24 - Just

Titus 1:8 - But a lover of hospitality, a lover of good men, sober, **just**, holy, temperate;

Just - "Right or righteous; Good **judgment**"

→ The word "just" carries the sense of having wisdom and the ability to judge matters properly according to the word of God; to discern between right and wrong and have the strength of character to make right decisions even it is difficult

The practical ways of becoming just are given in the word of God:

- ✓ It is the result of denying your own agenda in order to accomplish His - John 5:30
- ✓ When your judgments are not based on circumstances - John 7:24
- ✓ When you live by faith in God's truth not your perspective - Romans 1:17
- ✓ When you fear God - Acts 10:22, 34-35
- ✓ When you fall (because you will, nobody's perfect), you get back up – Prov. 24:16, Ecclesiastes 7:20
- ✓ God's word is just - Romans 7:12
    - Someone who ***JUST*** does the right thing. Makes the right judgement call. This comes from a deep wisdom and relationship with the word of God alone!

Some biblical examples of just men:

- Joseph: Matthew 1:19 -
- John the Baptist: Mark 6:20-
- Solomon: 1 Kings 3:16-28 –

#25 - Holy

Titus 1:8 - But a lover of hospitality, a lover of good men, sober, just, **holy**, temperate;

Holy = "Not a state of sinless perfection, but a daily lifestyle **set apart** unto God and from the world (Lev. 20:24-26; Rom. 12:1-2)"

- ✓ We are called to be holy (set apart) - 2 Cor. 6:14-18; Rom. 1:7
- ✓ We are to be holy because we are to be like Him - 1 Pt. 1:15-16
    - Some people over emphasize holiness (holiness movement, people who say salvation can be lost), but WE LAODICEANS underemphasize it (white raiment to be clothed)
        - Sexual sin; disgusting music, movies, tv shows, language, social media, conversations, jokes, dress (immodesty), etc… We are the church of "mixing the world with God"
        - Could anyone tell you were a Christian based on your: Spotify playlist, Netflix recently watched, social media feed, way you dress, the way you talk, the jokes you make? IF NOT, YOU ARE NOT LIVING SET APART

→ Holiness emphasized in the OT

The priests were to wash with water before entering the tabernacle, or they would die (Exo. 30:20-21)

- God takes our holiness very seriously!
- It is one of the things we will be judged on at the judgment seat of Christ (gold=holiness/sanctification to God)
- Of course, today we have the Holy Ghost living inside of us if we are saved and we can enter God's presence at any time because of the blood of Christ, but we still need to separate ourselves from sin and wickedness in our lives.
- What we do, we drag God into!!

How can we live a Holy life?

→ We are made holy by:

The holy blood that cleanses - 1 Pt. 1:18-19

The Holy Spirit that anoints - 2 Cor. 1:21-22; 1Jn. 2:27

The holy word that washes - Eph. 5:26; Jn. 17:17

**Holiness is the LIFE CALLING of a ministry leader! You will always be held to a higher standard! Just like the OT priests.

#26 - Temperate

Titus 1:8 - But a lover of hospitality, a lover of good men, sober, just, holy, **temperate**;

Temperate = "Moderate, not **excessive** in any area, having our actions and emotions under the Spirit's control… self-controlled" (1 Cor. 9:25; Php. 4:5; James 1:8)

Temperance is part of the fruit of the Spirit

- Temperance is the result of a daily walking in obedience to His Spirit - Gal. 5:23
- As such "intemperance" would be proof of being under the influence of the flesh
    - When my desires and emotions get the best of me it is evidence that I am not yielding to the working of God's Spirit in me at that moment - Gal. 5:23

Temperance is also a learned quality of character

- Just like holiness or love, God gives it to us by way of His Spirit at salvation…We have the responsibility to develop it through abiding in His word - 2 Pt. 1:5-8
- Temperance is seen in our willingness to surrender our own desires and preferences for the greater cause of reaching people - 1 Cor. 9:19-27
    - He equates this kind of living to an athlete. Discipline, training, and playing with PURPOSE and a GOAL, not out of control, willy nilly
    - Temperance is about being in control of your impulses, emotions, whims, etc. It relates to many other qualities we have looked at
    - Are you someone who is disciplined? Someone solid who can be counted on? Or are you prisoner to your every emotion, whim, and desire?

The Character Qualities of a Man or Woman of God

#27 - Holding fast the faithful word

Titus 1:9 - **Holding fast the faithful word** as he hath been taught, that he may be able by sound doctrine both to exhort and to convince the gainsayers.

Hold fast = "confidently holding the word of God, without wavering, even unto the end"

- 1 Sam. 3:19- As a young man, Samuel held onto every word of God dearly
  - Notice God was with him AND he grew. Why? Because he loved and dearly the word of God!

The man or woman of God must be doctrinally sound

- ✓ Proverbs 4:13- Refusing to let go the word of God (instruction) you've been given
- ✓ 2 Thess. 2:15 - Holding fast to what you have been taught from the word of God
- ✓ 2 Tim. 1:13-14 - Holding fast to the sound words committed to thee…
  - We must realize that someone is trying to take this truth out of our hands – 1 Tim. 4:1-2, 2 Tim. 4:1-4… Therefore we must be prepared to "earnestly contend for the faith" - Titus 1:9-11; Jude 3; 1 Pet. 3:15

A man or woman of God must learn how to use the Bible

- ✓ We must study the Bible so we will not be ashamed - 2 Tim. 2:15
- ✓ We must exercise in the word to become strong in the word - Heb. 5:11-14
  - We cannot stay "babies" in the word; we MUST grow up!
  - We may not know all we think we do; the devil has those who know much more than us, he is preparing and training up his false ministers too.
  - Our over confidence could make a mockery of the faith if we are not ready!
  - I'd watch videos of people we disagreed with and it would scare me to death to not have the answers needed, so I STUDIED! I studied what they believe, critics of what we believe, other faiths, etc. TO BE READY!

The Character Qualities of a Man or Woman of God

YOUNG WOMEN

"We all want clear, obvious, direct words from God on what he wants from us TODAY in our lives. For the next two weeks are are in luck. If you want to please God and know EXACTLY what his purpose is for you TODAY, we will be looking at his direct words to young men/women. God has a specific purpose/plan for how your life ought to look RIGHT NOW. If we listen and obey what he says, we can live in the purpose he has called us to"

Titus 2:4-5- That they may teach the young women to be sober, to love their husbands, to love their children, *To be* discreet, chaste, keepers at home, good, obedient to their own husbands, that the word of God be not blasphemed.

1 Timothy 5:14-15- I will therefore that the younger women marry, bear children, guide the house, give none occasion to the adversary to speak reproachfully. For some are already turned aside after Satan.

**NOTICE FIRST- the aged women are told to instruct the young women, NOT TITUS. There is a correct order to things here.

Make sure you are connecting to older women who you see living out the qualities that the Bible gives, not what YOU think a woman should be/do

Today the "young women" we will discuss are definitely right at/around the age of the young women in here today, however, due to culture differences of the time, they are assumed to be married and having kids already. Application can be made for preparing for this time in life, living these qualities with the authorities/opportunities given in your life now, and spiritually with Jesus Christ.

1. **Sober**- Thinking clearly; not "under the **influence**" of the world, flesh, devil; but the word of God
    a. We have looked at this quality many times already so we won't expound too much upon it. However, I believe God put this first to get our attention.
        i. He is saying: "LISTEN TO ME, don't be influenced by the world, or even the modern church, and all the feminist movement around the world; that is not how/what I made you for. It is a lie! Don't be under its influence!"
    b. Be open to the word of God today. Be under its influence and NOT under the influence of anything or anyone else. If you can't be "sober" on this, then you won't get the rest.
2. **Love their husbands and their children (in that order)**
    a. When connected with 1 Tim. 5:14-15, we see the reverence God gives to women who will be married, have kids, and guide/give for their home (live selfless)
        i. This is not the "popular, freeing, powerful, feminist" thing to do today, but God values it still.
    b. The enemy knows the power/influence of the home, that is why a MAJOR attack against the church in the last days is in the home (2 Tim. 3:1-6)
    c. To have a family like this and to love it (sacrifice/charity) is work and it is selfless. God values you not living for yourself, your desires, your dreams, your career, your…..(fill in the blank) BUT for a greater cause.
        i. God set the family order for a reason. To think your way is better or that usurping his order of things is better, is a lack of faith.
        ii. Loving your husband first, ultimately affects your kids the most!
            1. **Many studies have shown that kids who viewed their parents as "being in love" have a much higher rate of success in finance, education, less behavioral issues, etc.**
    d. Your influence on your husband and your kids and how that affects eternity is INCALCULABLE. But, it takes faith. It is not satisfying in the short term (instant gratification).
    e. Read these quotes from/about great missionaries and Christians through the years and what they say about this
3. **Discreet-** The literal sense is, separate, **reserved**, wary; prudent

a. The other 3 uses in the Bible of this word show the word associated with being "behind the scenes" or "unseen" (Gen. 41:33, 39; Mark 12:34)
b. We see this same posture for women talked about elsewhere in the Bible (1 Cor. 14:34-35; 1 Tim. 2:11-12)
    i. The fact that these verses cannot often even be talked about the correct biblical way in churches today is evidence of two things:
        1. The wresting (twisting) and mis-use of these verses for "lording" over women by insecure/ little men
        2. The feminist attitude and posture of many women today seeking to live how the world says they ought to, and not how the word of God commands they should
            a. Neither side would admit to these accusations, and both would give you "scripture" out of context in order to excuse their behavior, but these statements are still absolutely true.
    ii. It is a virtuous quality for a woman to have this posture. It shows humility, faith in God's word, self-control, and sober mindedness. They are influenced by God and nothing else.
        1. The point of these verses is not that women are less, should not ever talk, or are not needed; but rather that WHEN DONE THE PROPER WAY, they have the MOST influence possible doing it God's way, with the countenance and attitude God made them to have!
        2. No man likes a loud, contentious, busy-body woman. You are not made to like that. (Prov. 27:15; 21:9, 19; 9:13; 7:11)
            a. I have heard women pride themselves on being loud, stubborn, abrasive, having a "fighting spirit". This is not what you want to be associated with. Be what God says you should be, not anyone else.

4. **Chaste-** Pure; genuine; uncorrupt
    a. When we see this word used elsewhere in the Bible, it typically deals with **purity**
        i. Purity in sexuality- 2 Cor. 11:2
            1. Don't compromise on your purity sexually. God values it so much that he equates it to our faithfulness to him in our marriage to his son
            2. The world says that exploring your sexuality is freeing and the feminist movement teaches you that it is freeing/liberating; but God says that it is imprisoning/bondage to you (Prov. 5:22; 7:22-27; Rom. 6:16; 2 Pet. 2:19; John 8:34)
        ii. Purity in modesty- 1 Pet. 3:1-5
            1. Dressing modestly is directly linked by God in these verses to your submissive heart, meekness, and quietness.
            2. He is implying that to not be modest is connected to not being quiet, meek, submissive, AND VISE VERSA.
            3. Would anyone know you were a Christian by what you wear ALONE?
            4. Is your dress LOUD? Drawing unnecessary attention?
            5. This is why he connects the two. Wanting/desiring attention, whether in dress, speech, lifestyle, etc.. is not a godly attribute
5. **Keepers at home/Good/Obedient to Husbands**
    a. I linked these three together because they are similar to previous points and they speak to the same thing
    b. They all speak to a **submissive** attitude
        i. **Keepers at home**- Prov 7:11
            1. Notice where the strange woman's feet are; NOT AT HOME.
            2. This point is not just about being married and having kids (although this is a good thing to do) but about not living for yourself

a. The godly woman is not living HER LIFE, FOR HER, HER HAPPINESS, HER JOY, HER CAREER, ETC.. she is living for others (her family, disciples, church body, etc..)
   i. We see this all the time today with social media: me time, I need to find myself, my passion, my interests, my career, etc.. IT IS UNGODLY
b. If you are married/have kids or not, your life ought to be focused on helping and living for those around you/that you are close to (home); NOT YOURSELF

ii. **Good**- "Complete or sufficiently **perfect** in its kind; having the physical qualities best adapted to its design and use" (In the context of this passage and based on the law of first mention)- Gen. 1
   1. Doing what God made you to do, not what you think/desire to do in your flesh

iii. **Obedient to their own husbands**
   1. Submitting to the **authorities** in your life, as God placed them, the proper way (Eph 5:22)
      a. For married woman, to your OWN husbands, NOT all men everywhere
      b. For all: to government, to the ordained authorities in your life (pastor), to your bosses at work, teachers, etc..
      c. How you submit to the authorities in your life is how you submit to God
   2. Being able to submit to the authorities in your life as God has placed them, speaks volumes about your character and virtue as a woman
      a. God can use you in great ways, when you are willing to obey in these areas

6. That the word of God be not blasphemed/ That the name of God and his doctrine be not blasphemed

a. When these qualities are out of line and we choose to live based on how we think, the world dictates, or how we feel; then we give place for the word of God to be blasphemed! (2 Sam. 12:14; Rom. 2:24; 1 Tim. 6:1)
   i. When we subvert the word of God by thinking our way, our thinking, our feelings, are right and God is wrong; we give place for the enemies of God to blaspheme.
   ii. It is the same thing people say of those under them that they cannot control but they are supposed to (kids, workers, students, etc.. out of line)
      1. "Get your house/class/employees in order"
      2. "He can't even handle his own…"
         a. This is the enemies accusations of us when we don't submit to God's word

b. Today, let God be true and every man a liar. The Bible gives us CLEAR, NT passages on how we ought to live, specifically as young men/women. Don't listen to any other voices telling you anything outside of what God's word says on this. Submit and obey today and God will be glorified and not blasphemed.

The Character Qualities of a Man or Woman of God

YOUNG MEN

Titus 2:6-8- <u>Young men</u> likewise exhort to be sober minded. In all things shewing thyself a pattern of good works: in doctrine shewing uncorruptness, gravity, sincerity, Sound speech, that cannot be condemned; that he that is of the contrary part may be ashamed, having no evil thing to say of you.

1 John 2:13-14- I write unto you, fathers, because ye have known him that is from the beginning. I write unto you, **<u>young men</u>**, because ye have overcome the wicked one. I write unto you, little children, because ye have known the Father. I have written unto you, fathers, because ye have known him that is from the beginning. I have written unto you, **<u>young men</u>**, because ye are strong, and the word of God abideth in you, and ye have overcome the wicked one.

1. **Sober minded**- Thinking clearly; not "under the _____ " of the world, flesh, devil; but the word of God
    a. Be open to the word of God today. Be under its influence and NOT under the influence of anything or anyone else. If you can't be "sober" on this, then you won't get the rest.
    b. Especially for young men, God emphasizes this point in his word
2. **In all things shewing thyself a pattern of good works:-** A life that <u>consistently</u> shows a pattern of obedience and service to God
    a. Do you have this consistent pattern of good works? Are you someone that can be counted on, or are you showing signs of immaturity and always in a pattern of extreme highs and lows?
        i. Where does this pattern of good works come from?- 2 Tim. 3:16-17
        ii. What does this pattern of good works look like?- Neh.2:18; Titus 2:14
3. **In doctrine shewing…**
    a. **Uncorruptness/Gravity-** You need to be solid in your _____ and bible understanding, making sure you are not easily corrupted- 2 Cor. 2:17; 2 Tim. 1:13; Titus 2:1; 1:9
        i. You are at the place in life as a young man where God says you should be solid doctrinally
        ii. You should be able to not only stand in sound doctrine, but you should be able to defend the faith, defend the word of God, and convince others of the truth
        iii. We see this same idea in 1 Jn. 2:14- "the word of God abideth in you"
    b. **Sincerity-** To be _____ up with knowledge does you no good, charity edifieth. Are you sincere in your doctrine?- 2 Cor. 1:12; Philippians 1:9-10; Josh. 24:14 (1st mention)
        i. God says that young men are expected to be at this place in their walk. Understanding it is not about just your knowledge, but charity
        ii. People don't care about how much you know, until they know how much you care.
    c. **Sound speech that cannot be condemned-** Ultimately good doctrine should effect the way that you _____. When it is understood correctly and paired with sincerity, your speech will be sound and unable to be condemned- Eph. 4:19; 1 Cor. 15:33
4. **Ye are strong, and the word of God abideth in you, and ye have overcome the wicked one. -** God says that young men are expected to be in the place where they have overcome the devil BECAUSE they are strong/the word of God abideth in them- Matt. 13:19; Eph. 6:10-11; James 4:7
    a. The first mention of "wicked one" is in Matthew 13:19- From this we learn that one of the primary ways you can overcome the devil is by receiving and responding to the word of God whenever it is preached
    b. Think about _____ - What made David great, the KEY to his life, was that from the very time he was a young man, until he was an old king, with power, wisdom, money, etc.. HE LOVED THE WORD OF GOD and IT ABODE IN HIM- Psalm 119:11, 97, 104, 128, 163, 159, 167, etc

i. If you want to have victories like this, you must make sure you are strong in the Word of God!! To overcome the "wicked one"

c. Have you seen victory in your life over the devil? Is it consistent?

i. The answer to this is directly connected to your relationship to the word of God. Are you spending the time studying, loving, obeying it?

The Character Qualities of a Man or Woman of God

Week 1

Introduction

During this study we will examine 27 character qualities of a man or woman of God. It is important for us to understand that even though these character qualities are found in the texts dealing with the qualifications for a Pastor and Deacon, they are also the standard for every believer (both men and women).

- Acts 6:3; Acts 14:23; Titus 1:5

What are the character qualities?

- A multitude of evident personal character qualities - 1 Timothy 3:1-13; Titus 1:5-9
- The qualities are as follows:

1. Blameless
2. The husband of one wife
3. Vigilant
4. Sober
5. Grave
6. Of good behavior
7. Given to hospitality
8. Apt to teach
9. Not given to wine
10. Not doubletongued
11. No striker
12. Not greedy of filthy lucre
13. Patient
14. Not a brawler
15. Not slanderers
16. Not covetous
17. Ruleth well his own house
18. Not a novice
19. A good report to them which are without
20. Faithful in all things
21. Not self-willed
22. Not soon angry
23. A lover of good men
24. Just
25. Holy
26. Temperate
27. Holding fast the faithful word

**DURING THIS CLASS WE WILL BE MOVING THROUGH A LOT IN A SHORT TIME, THE KEY TO HELPING WITH THIS AND FOR YOU TO WALK AWAY WITH SOMETHING EACH WEEK IS THIS: MARK DOWN WITH A STAR/NOTES, 3 THINGS ON THE NOTES EACH WEEK THAT STAND OUT TO YOU THAT YOU NEED TO WORK ON. NO MORE THAN THIS, AND NO LESS!

#1 - Blameless

1 Timothy 3:2, 10 - 2 A bishop then must be **blameless**, the husband of one wife, vigilant, sober, of good behaviour, given to hospitality, apt to teach; …10 And let these also first be proved; then let them use the office of a deacon, being found **blameless**.

Titus 1:6-7 - 6 If any be **blameless**, the husband of one wife, having faithful children not accused of riot or unruly. 7 For a bishop must be **blameless**, as the steward of God; not selfwilled, not soon angry, not given to wine, no striker, not given to filthy lucre.

Definition of "Blameless":	*"free from blame or the just imputation of fault, **NOT** sinless or un-accused"*

The Character Qualities of a Man or Woman of God

1st Mention:	Genesis 44:10 - "And he said, Now also let it be according unto your words: he with whom it is found shall be my servant; and ye shall be blameless."

Having a blameless character means that others are not able to justly accuse you of being wrong or doing wrong. When accusations are thrown, they will not stick. Since no one is perfect, we will all likely violate this character quality, along with the others we will be studying. When this happens in our life and we are aware of it, we need to accept personal responsibility, confess our sin, deal with the consequences, and move forward with Christ!

Blameless is the most important character quality…

- It is the first quality listed in 1 Timothy 3:2, and it is mentioned twice in Titus 1:6-7
- It is the standard for all believers - Phil. 2:13-15; 1 Thess. 5:23; 2 Pt. 3:14; 1 Jn. 3:3
- It is the foundation for all the other character qualities and it is part of Gods great plan for your life– Eph. 1:4
- Your behavior can cause your MINISTRY to be blamed; therefore we must remain blameless- 2 Cor. 6:3

As followers of the Jesus Christ, we ought to be blameless before the Lord, other believers, and the world…

- 1 Cor. 10:31-32; 11:1; 2 Cor. 1:12; 6:3; Phil. 1:10; 3:17; 1 Tim. 5:14; 6:1; Tts. 2:5; 2 Sam. 12:14; 1 Pt. 2:21-23
  - When you follow the Lord, you can and will be blamed for many things, especially as a leader. What you need to do is make sure that it is not able to stick because you are blameless. Sometimes this means simply making a wrong doing, right; or it can mean to simply stay out of situations where you can be blamed.
  - We all WILL make mistakes, misspeak, and let others down; they key is humility to make it right always so that you are blameless. This is a non-negotiable in ministry. If you cannot do this then you will not be fruitful in your ministry.

#2 - The husband of one wife

1 Timothy 3:2 - A bishop then must be blameless, **the husband of one wife**, vigilant, sober, of good behaviour, given to hospitality, apt to teach;

Titus 1:6 - If any be blameless, **the husband of one wife**, having faithful children not accused of riot or unruly.

The husband of one wife = "Complete and total devotion to one mate; a one-woman man"

(Since nobody in here is married yet, apply these to your spiritual husband, Jesus Christ)

- ✓ Faithful with eyes - Job 31:1
- ✓ Faithful with mind - 2 Cor. 11:2-3
- ✓ Faithful with heart - Dan. 1:8; Matt. 15:18-19

Single people need to develop this area properly

- Some things are reserved for marriage only - Heb. 13:4; Gen. 1:27-28; 2:21, 24
- Singleness is a high calling - 1 Cor. 7:17-24; Phil 4:11; Heb. 13:5
- The advantages of singleness - 1 Cor. 7:32-45; Matt. 13:22
- Be pure - 1 Cor. 6:15-20; Rom. 6:12-13; 1 Pt. 2:11; Eph. 5:3

- Be someone who is FAITHFUL: to God now, to your spouse later. This can even start now with your dating/engagement time of life.
- Someone who is a "flirt" is not a good person to pursue. They are already showing signs of not being a "one woman kind of man" or a "one man kind of woman".

#3 - Vigilant

1 Timothy 3:2 - A bishop then must be blameless, the husband of one wife, **vigilant**, sober, of good behaviour, given to hospitality, apt to teach;

Vigilant = "to watch; to keep watch; stay awake; alert and watchful especially to danger; to be ready; surveillance; prepared; focused (*The guard was on an all-night vigil*)"

- ✓ Watchful is a good synonym

  Genesis 2:15 - "And the LORD God took the man, and put him into the garden of Eden to dress it and *to keep it*."

Watchful for yourself

- ✓ Watch and pray concerning areas of fleshly temptation/personal weakness - Matt. 26:38-41; 1 Cor. 10:12-13

Watchful for those whom God has given you

- ✓ Watch to feed - Acts 20:28; 1 Pt. 5:2-3
- ✓ Watch for wolves from without - Acts 20:29; 2 Pt. 2:1
- ✓ Watch for wolves from within - Acts 20:30-31; Ezek. 34:1-4
- ✓ Watch in prayer for all the saints - Eph. 6:18; 1:15-16
- ✓ Watch and pray for open doors - Col. 4:2-4; Eph. 6:19
- ✓ Watch for the tendency to be pulled away from preaching of the word - 2 Tim. 4:1-5; Jer. 5:31; Lk. 6:26; 2 Pt. 2:1-3
  - Is your life in a place that you are able to help others?
  - Who have you helped in this ministry? How?
  - How is your prayer life for this ministry?

The Character Qualities of a Man or Woman of God

Week 2

#4 - Sober

1 Timothy 3:2, 11 - 2 A bishop then must be blameless, the husband of one wife, vigilant, **sober**, of good behaviour, given to hospitality, apt to teach; …11 Even so must their wives be grave, not slanderers, **sober**, faithful in all things.

Titus 1:8 - But a lover of hospitality, a lover of good men, **sober**, just, holy, temperate;

Sober = "to be sensible; to have control of your mind, emotions, senses and impulses in all circumstances"

- This is especially true of young people (young men are warned of this as we will see later). You have a zeal and fire in you that helps BUT can hinder you if you are not careful

- Sober and vigilant (watchful) are closely related - 1 Tim. 3:2
  - ✓ 1 Pt. 1:13 - "…gird up the loins of your mind, be sober…"
  - ✓ Phil. 4:5 - "Let your moderation be known to all men…"
  - ✓ 1 Cor. 9:25 - "…temperate in all things…"
- Important questions to ask yourself…
  1. What are the things that take control of my **mind**?- Titus 2:6
  2. What are the things that take control of my **emotions**?- Daniel 1:8; Ephesians 5:26
     - These verses show us that the world is trying to bring you "under the influence", maybe using things like "influencers" and social media. To think, believe, and act differently than you know to when you are "sober"
     - It is great to have zeal, but if you are not sober minded and you are brought under the influence of something else then you will make unwise choices that have lasting effects, BUT YOU WONT KNOW IT IN THE MOMENT
     - Interestingly enough, water is what is used to "sober" people up, and we see in Ephesians 5:26 that this water for us, is the word of God

#5 - Grave

1 Timothy 3:4, 8, 11 - 4 One that ruleth well his own house, having his children in subjection with all **gravity**; …8 Likewise must the deacons be **grave**, not doubletongued, not given to much wine, not greedy of filthy lucre; …11 Even so must their wives be **grave**, not slanderers, sober, faithful in all things.

Grave = "Something momentous, weighty, influential, of great importance; to be serious, solemn, sober"

- ✓ It means to take things that are serious seriously
  - There is a time for joking and fun, BUT there are times and things that require full attention and all seriousness.
- ✓ Do you take seriously:
  - Your sin?- Galatians 6:7-8
  - The salvation of those around you?- Rev. 20:15
  - The growth of this ministry?
  - The word of God?- John 1:1

- Personal holiness?- 1 Thess. 4:3-4
- Prayer?- Luke 22:44
- Etc..

#6 - Of good behaviour

1 Timothy 3:2 - A bishop then must be blameless, the husband of one wife, vigilant, sober, **of good behaviour**, given to hospitality, apt to teach;

Of good behaviour = "Orderly; well-arranged"- 1 Sam. 18:14

*9/20 mentions of "behave" in the Bible are talking about how David "behaved" himself

Good behaviour has to do with specific areas:

- ✓ Orderly in our daily life - 1 Thess. 2:10; 2 Cor. 4:2
- ✓ Orderly in our work ethic - 2 Thess. 3:6-11; 1 Pt. 5:2-3

It is becoming of the gospel for us to be of good behaviour:

Note: We are His ambassadors (ambassadors of good will) - 2 Cor. 5:20

#7 - Given to hospitality

1 Timothy 3:2 - A bishop then must be blameless, the husband of one wife, vigilant, sober, of good behaviour, **given to hospitality**, apt to teach;

Titus 1:8 - But **a lover of hospitality**, a lover of good men, sober, just, holy, temperate;

Given to hospitality = "Giving; Friendly; Being sensitive to the needs of others; Developed from the word hospital…to care for; A friendly treatment of guests and strangers."

Hospitable toward:

- Believers
  - Gal. 6:10 - "…especially unto them who are of the household of faith."
  - 1 Jn. 3:17 - "But whoso hath this world's good, and seeth his brother hath need…"
- Non-Believers
  - Hospitality tested:
    - ✓ Heb. 13:2 - "Be not forgetful to entertain strangers…" (Entertain strangers = Hospitality!)
  - Strangers typified:
    - ✓ Lev. 19:34 - "…for ye were strangers in the land of Egypt:"

      * Loving strangers is the heart of God - Deut. 10:17-19; Lev. 19:34

Note: How we respond to the lost is a great indicator of our love for God!

Hospitality is the willingness to let God use whatever he has given you to help others…

- ✓ What are ways in which you can exercise hospitality to believers?
- ✓ What are ways in which you can exercise hospitality to non-believers?

The Character Qualities of a Man or Woman of God

#8 - Apt to teach

1 Timothy 3:2 - A bishop then must be blameless, the husband of one wife, vigilant, sober, of good behaviour, given to hospitality, **apt to teach**;

Titus 1:9 - Holding fast the faithful word as he hath been taught, that he may be able by sound doctrine both to **exhort and to convince the gainsayers**.

This is a learned character quality for every child of God to develop (Some are gifted to teach, this goes beyond one's ability to learn - Eph. 4:8, 11)

The first mention:

- Exodus 4:10-12 - **Availability**, not ability, is the key
  - Are you available to open your mouth and "teach" the Bible to those who you interact with? Are you willing?

This also means we need to be investing in " learning" the word, so that we can be ready to "teach" it

You can only teach what you have been taught - 2 Tim. 2:2; 2 Tim. 2:15; 1 Tim. 4:16

- ✓ What kind of learner am I?
- ✓ How well do I pay attention?
- ✓ How well do I listen to others?
- ✓ How is my Bible study time?
- ✓ Do I learn from circumstances of life easily?
- ✓ Do I seek out opportunities to learn from/follow others who I know can help me learn even more?

- You are at a time in life where you can/should be building a large foundation of your learning the Bible. You have the time, resources, lower level of responsibility, and God tells us that it should be one of the focuses of your age (1 Jn. 2:14)

The Character Qualities of a Man or Woman of God

Week 3

#9 - Not given to wine

1 Timothy 3:3, 8 - 3 **Not given to wine**, no striker, not greedy of filthy lucre; but patient, not a brawler, not covetous; … 8 Likewise must the deacons be grave, not doubletongued, **not given to much wine**, not greedy of filthy lucre;

Titus 1:7 - For a bishop must be blameless, as the steward of God; not selfwilled, not soon angry, **not given to wine**, no striker, not given to filthy lucre;

The word of God condemns drunkenness:

- ✓ Eph. 5:18 - "And be not drunk with wine…"
- ✓ 1 Pt. 4:2-3 - "…the time past of our life…when we walked in…excess of wine…"
- ✓ Prov. 20:1 - "Wine is a mocker, strong drink is raging: and whoever is deceived thereby is not wise."
- ✓ Prov. 23:29-35 - "…it biteth like a serpent…"

The wise man or woman avoids it:

- ✓ Lev. 10:9 - No alcohol permitted while serving in the capacity of a priest
- ✓ Prov. 31:4 - Kings and priests were to avoid strong drink - 1 Pt. 2:5, 9; Rev. 1:6; 5:10

The bible very carefully and specifically defines our attitude toward alcohol:

- ✓ Allowances were only for medicinal purposes - 1 Tim. 5:23
- ✓ Interpreting our culture:
  - → The #1 killer of teenagers is alcohol related auto accidents
  - → The #1 factor in domestic violence is alcohol
  - → A major component of immorality is intoxication

Note: You can justify anything if you really want to. The Bible does NOT make provisions for us to drink socially. Total abstinence is the best policy regarding alcohol consumption. However, if you really want to violate God's word, God will let you fool yourself - Ezek. 14:1-4, 9; Matt. 13; Jer. 23.

The Bible says that nothing should control our lives but the Holy Spirit… and we can be drunk on many things

- ✓ 1 Co. 6:12; 1 Thess. 5:5-8; Ephesians 5:18

#10 - Not doubletongued

1 Timothy 3:8 - Likewise must the deacons be grave, **not doubletongued**, not given to much wine, not greedy of filthy lucre;

Doubletongued = "double in speech; saying one thing with one and another thing with another; a type of lying"

- ✓ This is the only time this word in used in the Bible
- ✓ See James 1:8; 3:3-12(verse 10 especially)
  - o Our tongue should not be a place where we bless God and yet curse others
  - o This kind of speaking will kill a ministry. Gossip and ill speaking will kill a ministry, friendships, and your personal walk with the Lord. (Jeremiah 9:3,5,,8-9)

- God HATES this kind of behavior (Prov. 6:16-19)

This can be best understood by just reading the scripture…

- ✓ Watch out for flatterers - Ps. 12:1-3; 5:9
- ✓ Watch out for liars - Ps. 50:19; 52:2; Rom. 3:13; Eph. 4:25; James 5:12 (let your yea be yea and your nay be nay)
- ✓ What your mouth should be: a well of life, ministering to others- Prov. 10:11; Eph. 4:29
- ✓ The Bottom Line- A mature Christian who is to lead God's people, cannot and will not participate in this kind of behavior. It will **kill** your ministry and any chance of growth you have in it.

#11 - No striker

1 Timothy 3:3 - Not given to wine, **no striker**, not greedy of filthy lucre; but patient, not a brawler, not covetous;

Titus 1:7 - For a bishop must be blameless, as the steward of God; not selfwilled, not soon angry, not given to wine, **no striker**, not given to filthy lucre;

No striker = "**Uncontrolled** anger to the point of physical violence"

- ✓ A Striker is someone who is ready to fight

There are striking biblical examples:

- ✓ Genesis 4:8- And Cain talked with Abel his brother: and it came to pass, when they were in the field, that Cain rose up against Abel his brother, and slew him.
  - We can fight or strike our brethren out of jealousy/envy to tear them down
- ✓ Exodus 2:11-12- And it came to pass in those days, when Moses was grown, that he went out unto his brethren, and looked on their burdens: and he spied an Egyptian smiting an Hebrew, one of his brethren. And he looked this way and that way, and when he saw that *there was* no man, he slew the Egyptian, and hid him in the sand.
- ✓ John 18:10-11- Then Simon Peter having a sword drew it, and smote the high priest's servant, and cut off his right ear. The servant's name was Malchus.
  - We can fight/strike others for "just causes". We should not find ourselves in a constant state of fighting and turmoil, it may show we have a "striker" nature.
- ✓ Don't always be so quick to "vindicate yourself" and make yourself have to be "right" in all situations. Seek peace first. Oftentimes this means bearing the **burdens** of others!- Rom. 15:1-3; Luke 6:29
  - It is our "American" posture, but it was NOT the posture of Christ to always "be made right" and make sure they were treated justly and that they were vindicated. Not being a striker means to seek peace and bearing burdens.

Violent abuse can also be verbal

- ✓ A striker usually begins with **verbally** abusing others
- ✓ James 3:1-10 - There is more than one way to hurt someone
- ✓ Proverbs 10:19; 17:27-28 - A man or woman of God should be known for their good words as well as for their good works
  - Don't be QUICK to fight. With your words or your actions. Seek peace (Romans 12:18) when at all possible.

The Character Qualities of a Man or Woman of God

#12 - Not greedy of filthy lucre

1 Timothy 3:3 - Not given to wine, no striker, **not greedy of filthy lucre**; but patient, not a brawler, not covetous;

Titus 1:7 - For a bishop must be blameless, as the steward of God; not selfwilled, not soon angry, not given to wine, no striker, **not given to filthy lucre**;

Filthy lucre = "Money received through improper methods or motives"

→ A.K.A. - "Dirty Money"

Improper methods:

- Usury (interest): exploiting the crisis of others - Prov. 28:8; Lev. 25:35-37
- Get rich quick schemes - gambling, lottery, high risk investments, etc. - Prov. 13:11

  *Vanity = Empty; with no value - Jer. 17:11; Prov. 28:8, 20, 22
- Bribes and deceit: Deut. 16:19; Prov. 17:23; 1 Sam. 8:1-3

Improper motives:

- Greed – Matthew 6:24
- Desire for power – Matt. 23:12
- Covetousness/Security through materialism – Luke 12:15-21

Money problems are generally not an issue of amount but of attitude

The proper attitude is one of contentment - 1 Tim. 6:6-8; Prov. 30:8-9; Heb. 13:5

✓ A man must be proven in this area before becoming a pastor - 1 Pt. 5:2

The Character Qualities of a Man or Woman of God

Week 4

#13 - Patient

1 Timothy 3:3 - Not given to wine, no striker, not greedy of filthy lucre; but **patient**, not a brawler, not covetous;

Patient = "the ability to bear adversity without complaint"

Patience is a developed character quality.

- It is often associated with being developed in times of temptations and trials- James 1:2-4

→ Patience is learned, but it does not always have to be learned the hard way!

Patience is a requirement for those who minister God's word and lead others

- It is a key quality for God's leaders in ministry -2 Corinthians 6:4-10
  - While we endure these trials and persecutions, God is teaching us patience. It is a quality you can only learn really through time and experience
- Ministry is oftentimes loveless, burdensome, and has little "reward" in it for the minister from those they minister to. Therefore patience in pressing forward is needed- 2 Cor. 12:15
  - Patience in serving, giving, ministering, loving, taking criticism, taking hatred, taking evil speaking, etc.. is needed
- Patience truly is learning to trust God and his word in times of troubles and persecutions. Abraham was a great example- Gen. 12:1-3; 13:15; 15:1-6; 16:1-3; 17:15-19; 21:1-2; Heb 11:8-10,17
  - When God's promises and his "word" start to not make sense because of troubles around us, when we learn to trust his word anyway and wait on him, we are learning patience.

#14 - Not a brawler

1 Timothy 3:3 - Not given to wine, no striker, not greedy of filthy lucre; but patient, **not a brawler**, not covetous;

Brawler = "one who constantly seeks a confrontation; one who enjoys a fight; macho-man; armed for combat"

Some causes of brawling:

✓ Pride - Prov. 13:10

- Do you find yourself in constant contention, drama, or surrounded by issues? You are called to not be a brawler. Pride comes with contention. This is the opposite of the "burden bearing" leader

✓ Proud Debating - 2 Tim. 2:23; Titus 3:9

- Even when dealing with other believers or the lost about things, don't find yourself in constant struggles and "debates". It is a sign of immaturity
- There is nothing wrong with helping others and teaching them (Adam, London) but if you find yourself in contention, pride is somewhere.

Note: Satan started the brawl…"I will be like the most high." - Isaiah 14:13-14

→ Some people just seem to consistently find themselves in conflict

Some questions to ask yourself

- ✓ Do I have a team-mentality, or am I totally independent? - Eph. 4:1-3
- ✓ Do I display a servant's **heart** or self-centeredness? - Phil. 2:1-5
- ✓ Do I seek areas of agreement or disagreement? – Rom. 12:18
- ✓ Do I look for people's strengths or their weaknesses?- Rom. 15:1-2
- ✓ Would my authorities (employer, husband, etc.) say I was submissive in heart? - 2 Pt. 2:10; Jude 8

#15 - Not slanderers

1 Timothy 3:11 - Even so must their wives be grave, **not slanderers**, sober, faithful in all things.

Slanderer = "one that falsely accuses another; acting the part of the devil"

- ✓ Satan is known as the "accuser of our brethren" - Rev. 12:9-10; 2 Tim. 3:3
- ✓ They are false accusations against "brethren" (i.e. soundly saved Christians) because Jesus Christ took our iniquity upon Himself and we received His spotless righteousness in return- Is. 53:4-6; 2 Cor. 5:19-21

→ We are to follow the biblical procedure to restore our brothers/sisters who are overtaken in a fault; not doing so and simply slandering our brothers/sisters will KILL our ministry (Gal. 6:1-2; 2 Sam. 12:1-15; Psalm 51; Matt. 18:15-17)

What this does not mean…

It is not slander to warn others of **false** teachers and heretics. It is not godly to remain silent when false prophets are leading others "off the cliff" of sound doctrine. We still apply Galatians 6:1-2 first, but after that it's time to contend for the faith…loudly if necessary! Eternity is at stake for billions of people! - Titus 1:9-11

The Character Qualities of a Man or Woman of God

Week 5

#16 - Not covetous

1 Timothy 3:3 - Not given to wine, no striker, not greedy of filthy lucre; but patient, not a brawler, **not covetous**;

Covetousness is defined as idolatry in Colossians 3:5 and Ephesians 5:3-7 - Eager to have more…

- Covetousness declares that God is not enough - Ps. 119:57; 73:25-26

Covetousness is the root cause of much sin

- It is the root of all evil - 1 Tim. 6:10
- It is at the heart of false teaching - 1 Tim. 6:10; 2 Pt. 2:1-3
- It is worthy of separation - 1 Cor. 5:11

Covetousness can become a lifestyle, if it is not controlled

- In relation to material things – Luke 12:15-21
  - The problem with covetousness is that it goes directly against relying upon God, it is directly against the life of FAITH (God is everything, trusting him in everything)
  - God emphasized the sabbath with Israel so much because it was an issue of FAITH and GOD over MONEY and COVETEOUSNESS

Always Remember…

- ✓ A godly man or woman should hate covetousness! - Ex. 18:21 (first mention)
- ✓ The word of God can replace covetousness - Ps. 119:36
  - Think of the KEY of David, THE LOVE OF THE WORD OF GOD; verses the ROOT OF all evil, the LOVE OF MONEY (ye cannot serve God and mammon. You will love one master and hate the other)

#17 - Ruleth well his own house

1 Timothy 3:4-5 - 4 One that **ruleth well his own house**, having his children in subjection with all gravity; 5 (For if a man know not how to **rule his own house**, how shall he take care of the church of God?)

Titus 1:6 - If any be blameless, the husband of one wife, **having faithful children not accused of riot or unruly**.

Ruleth well his own house = "One that rules (or leads) his home in a godly, upright manner, fitting of a true follower of Jesus Christ"

→ Defining this quality is easy: *it means what it says, and says what it means…*

This qualification is a noticeable test for leadership:

-How a man rules his home will be how he rules the church - 1 Tim. 3:5

The principle is clear:

- ✓ My family is the mirror God uses to expose my areas of weakness

How this work in your life today as a youth:

- ✓ Your disciples are a reflection of you (your "spiritual child")- 1 Tim. 1:2; 2 Tim. 2:1
  - o If you have none or you have never led anyone to the Lord, then that is a reflection of you (not an exact but a measurement)
- ✓ Your ministry is a reflection of you
  - o What are you doing for the Lord?
  - o What place do you have in this ministry?
  - o What have you contributed?
  - o Do you have a "ministry" within this "ministry"?
- ✓ Your "fruit" is a reflection of you
  - o The fruit of your life speaks of who you are
  - o What fruit do you have?
  - o How well do you rule what God has entrusted to you (whatever it is)?

#18 - Not a novice

1 Timothy 3:6 - **Not a novice**, lest being lifted up with pride he fall into the condemnation of the devil.

Novice - "Someone in a position of leadership before they are qualified… not experienced"

- → The term refers specifically to a new believer, but carries with it the idea of someone who has not been trained, tested, and proven
- → It is possible to be saved for a long time and still be a novice - 1 Cor. 3:1; Heb. 5:12-13.
- → The issue is one of maturity rather than time

A novice has a special danger of pride. Authority and power can, and usually does, corrupt. Therefore, it is vital that they be tested and proven.

- ✓ Children's ministry - No glory, just responsibility…How does he serve?
- ✓ Adult ministry - Is he diligent? Does he take initiative? Do godly people follow him?
- ✓ Discipleship - How seriously does he approach his commitment to others?
- ✓ General volunteer work - Does he have a submissive heart attitude?

A novice cannot develop these character qualities overnight or by going to school - They must be lived daily…

- ✓ Abraham was 25 years in preparing to be a father
- ✓ Moses was 40 years in preparing to be a deliverer
- ✓ Paul was at least 15 years preparing for his first missionary journey

Note: It is the responsibility of leadership to guard the body of Christ from a novice. Proper testing and training must be part of any local New Testament church structure

#19 - A good report to them which are without

1 Timothy 3:7 - Moreover he must have **a good report of them which are without**; lest he fall into reproach and the snare of the devil.

A good report to them which are without - "Having a good testimony in the **lost** world"

There is no other option…It does matter what the world thinks of us:

→ That we might be able to win them - 1 Cor. 9:19-22; 10:31-33

→ To keep criticism of Christianity at a minimum - 2 Cor. 6:3; 1 Pt. 2:12, 15

→ Note: Remember what the apostle Paul wrote in Philippians 2:14-16…

Test yourself:

- ✓ What is my testimony in the lost world?
- ✓ Is there truth in the lost world's criticism of me?
- ✓ Is it my beliefs or my attitude that people reject?
- ✓ Would my financial report allow me to witness to an employee at my bank?
- ✓ If someone referenced you in a conversation, would that person's ability to be a witness be helped or hindered?

Caution: We are at odds with the lost world because of the word of God and the testimony of Jesus. We will be criticized even when we have not done anything wrong. Give other believers the benefit of the doubt when hearing criticisms concerning them. Keep this in mind when attacks focus on our personalities and characters. Remember, we will suffer for this testimony, so do not expect to get an award from the lost world for witnessing to them.

A great example:

- Timothy- Acts 16:1-3

#20 - Faithful in all things

1 Timothy 3:11 - Even so must their wives be grave, not slanderers, sober, **faithful in all things**.

Faithful in all things - "faithful in everything; worthy of trust in all things"

- ✓ This is also specifically addressed to wives of deacons. Men (or in this case deacons) obviously should also be faithful in all things. In fact, the husbands should be spiritually teaching and leading their wives in this area- 1 Cor. 14:34-35; 1 Tim. 2:11-14; Eph. 5:22-24

Faithful can be broken down as someone who is "full of faith"; is this descriptive of your life?

- ✓ Hebrews 11- Do you trust God/his word even when the world tells you it is crazy?
- ✓ Are you someone that can be counted on? By God and other people?- Luke 16:10

#21 - Not self-willed

Titus 1:7 - For a bishop must be blameless, as the steward of God; **not selfwilled**, not soon angry, not given to wine, no striker, not given to filthy lucre;

Self-Willed = "Not yielding to the wishes of others; stubborn; obstinate; willful adherence to one's own desires or ideas; controlled by one's own will; someone full of self (pride); one who only wants things done their way"

Note: This is especially prevalent in false teachers - 2 Pt. 2:10; Jude 8

→ Therefore, someone who is not self-willed wants things done God's way…



The Character Qualities of a Man or Woman of God

When we are not self-willed we will tend to give God the glory rather than ourselves:

- He should have the pre-eminence - Col. 1:18; 3 Jn. 9
- HIS will, not OUR will, should be our focus- Mt. 26:39, 42
    - This is all about the will of God, seeking God and his kingdom, his glory first. NOT our plans, our will, our thoughts.
    - We can have and express our thoughts to God, but we must be willing to submit, and not be selfwilled.

Personal evaluation:

- ✓ Would the people in my home, office, or sphere of influence say that I am self-willed?
- ✓ Does everything usually end up going my way?
- ✓ Do people seem to adjust to or work around my personality?
- ✓ Am I a quitter (do I give up easily)?
- ✓ Am I a good follower?

The Character Qualities of a Man or Woman of God

WEEK 6

#22 - Not soon angry

Titus 1:7 - For a bishop must be blameless, as the steward of God; not selfwilled, **not soon angry**, not given to wine, no striker, not given to filthy lucre;

Not soon angry = "A person who is seldom angry; a person who is not angered easily; a person who, when angry for a just cause, is not angry for long (Jas. 1:19)

Anger is not always sin… proper, biblical anger exists - Mk. 3:5; Ps. 7:11

- Matthew 5:22 - Without a cause… there must be a time when there is a cause
- Ephesians 4:26-27 - Be ye angry and sin not… there must be a sinless anger

Anger is sin when:

- When it is kept in and not dealt with - Eph. 4:26-27
  - ✓ If we do not deal with anger we give the Devil a foot-hold
- When it seeks revenge - Rom. 12:19-21
  - ✓ Taking vengeance is taking the position of God
  - ✓ It means I have been overcome
- When it is for selfish reasons - Gen. 4:1-8; Jonah 4:1; Lk. 15:28
  - ✓ Would it bother me as bad if this was done to someone else?

Note: Jesus' anger was always in regard to the violation of God's righteousness or God's people - Matt. 21:12-13; Mk. 3:1-5

Anger is caused by:

- Pride: When my rights have been violated - Jas. 4:1
  - ✓ We cannot consider ourselves spirit controlled when bitterness remains a part of our lives - Jas. 3:13-18
- Insecurity/Envy: A result from feeling threatened in position or relationships - 1 Sam. 18:6-9
    - o Saul Jealous over David and the people reverencing David and his victories
  - ✓ How do I respond to those who question my authority?
  - ✓ Do I become frustrated when my routines are interrupted?
  - ✓ How do I react when my control is lost?
- Foolishness: Anger is evidence of lack of wisdom - Prov. 12:16; 27:3; Eccl. 7:9
- Anger is a secondary emotion: it is always caused by something else: the root of the problem is **something else**

Anger results in:

- Vulnerability: Spiritual sickness…You become easily controlled by the enemy and predictable - Prov. 25:28; 16:32
  - ✓ Open to demonic influence: Eph. 4:26-27
      - o Neither give place to the devil

Anger is to be dealt with biblically:

- ✓ **Yield your rights to God…you are His** - 1 Cor. 6:19-20; **Learn to rest in him** - Ps. 37:7-8; **Use a soft answer** - Prov. 15:1; **Walk in the spirit** - Gal. 5:16-25; **Pass over faults…remember, he passed over our faults** - Prov. 12:16; 19:11; **Listen twice as much as you speak** - Jas. 1:20; 3:2-10; **Saturate your mind with scripture dealing with anger** - Ps. 119:9-11

#23 - A lover of good men

Titus 1:8 - But a lover of hospitality, **a lover of good men**, sober, just, holy, temperate;

A Good Man = "An upright and **perfect** man" (Prov. 2:20-21)

→ Although we are all sinners and are careful not to define ourselves as good, the Bible clearly tells us to be lovers of good men. This obviously means there must be good, godly men. (Not good in and of ourselves…)

Additional biblical credentials of a good man:

- ✓ Saved men - Matthew 13:38
- ✓ Fruit-bearing men - Matthew 13:23; 7:15-20
- ✓ Stable men - Psalm 37:23-24
- ✓ Benevolent and honest men - Psalm 112:5
  - o Who you are surrounded by WILL EFFECT YOU. It is a reflection of you. It says a lot about you. Be careful of who you are surrounded by. Make sure they are good men/women according to the BIBLE!

Some practical things that identify good men:

- ✓ A good man lives by faith - Romans 4, Hebrews 11
- ✓ A good man is hated by evil and wicked men - Prov. 29:27
- ✓ A good man avoids evil - Prov. 16:17
- ✓ A good man desires to be sharpened by his friends - Prov. 27:17
  - → *A good man is not intimidated, but rather challenged, by the goodness of others*
- ✓ A good man will find encouragement in his friend's counsel - Prov. 27:9
  - → *Our intimate friendships reveal much about our character*

WEEK 7

#24 - Just

Titus 1:8 - But a lover of hospitality, a lover of good men, sober, **just**, holy, temperate;

Just - "Right or righteous; Good **judgment**"

→ The word "just" carries the sense of having wisdom and the ability to judge matters properly according to the word of God; to discern between right and wrong and have the strength of character to make right decisions even it is difficult

The practical ways of becoming just are given in the word of God:

- ✓ It is the result of denying your own agenda in order to accomplish His - John 5:30
- ✓ When your judgments are not based on circumstances - John 7:24
- ✓ When you live by faith in God's truth not your perspective - Romans 1:17
- ✓ When you fear God - Acts 10:22, 34-35
- ✓ When you fall (because you will, nobody's perfect), you get back up – Prov. 24:16, Ecclesiastes 7:20
- ✓ God's word is just - Romans 7:12
    - Someone who ***JUST*** does the right thing. Makes the right judgement call. This comes from a deep wisdom and relationship with the word of God alone!

Some biblical examples of just men:

- Joseph: Matthew 1:19 -
- John the Baptist: Mark 6:20-
- Solomon: 1 Kings 3:16-28 –

#25 - Holy

Titus 1:8 - But a lover of hospitality, a lover of good men, sober, just, **holy**, temperate;

Holy = "Not a state of sinless perfection, but a daily lifestyle **set apart** unto God and from the world (Lev. 20:24-26; Rom. 12:1-2)"

- ✓ We are called to be holy (set apart) - 2 Cor. 6:14-18; Rom. 1:7
- ✓ We are to be holy because we are to be like Him - 1 Pt. 1:15-16
    - Some people over emphasize holiness (holiness movement, people who say salvation can be lost), but WE LAODICEANS underemphasize it (white raiment to be clothed)
        - Sexual sin; disgusting music, movies, tv shows, language, social media, conversations, jokes, dress (immodesty), etc… We are the church of "mixing the world with God"
        - Could anyone tell you were a Christian based on your: Spotify playlist, Netflix recently watched, social media feed, way you dress, the way you talk, the jokes you make? IF NOT, YOU ARE NOT LIVING SET APART

→ Holiness emphasized in the OT

The priests were to wash with water before entering the tabernacle, or they would die (Exo. 30:20-21)

- God takes our holiness very seriously!
- It is one of the things we will be judged on at the judgment seat of Christ (gold=holiness/sanctification to God)
- Of course, today we have the Holy Ghost living inside of us if we are saved and we can enter God's presence at any time because of the blood of Christ, but we still need to separate ourselves from sin and wickedness in our lives.
- What we do, we drag God into!!

How can we live a Holy life?

→ We are made holy by:

The holy blood that cleanses - 1 Pt. 1:18-19

The Holy Spirit that anoints - 2 Cor. 1:21-22; 1Jn. 2:27

The holy word that washes - Eph. 5:26; Jn. 17:17

**Holiness is the LIFE CALLING of a ministry leader! You will always be held to a higher standard! Just like the OT priests.

#26 - Temperate

Titus 1:8 - But a lover of hospitality, a lover of good men, sober, just, holy, **temperate**;

Temperate = "Moderate, not **excessive** in any area, having our actions and emotions under the Spirit's control… self-controlled" (1 Cor. 9:25; Php. 4:5; James 1:8)

Temperance is part of the fruit of the Spirit

- Temperance is the result of a daily walking in obedience to His Spirit - Gal. 5:23
- As such "intemperance" would be proof of being under the influence of the flesh
    - When my desires and emotions get the best of me it is evidence that I am not yielding to the working of God's Spirit in me at that moment - Gal. 5:23

Temperance is also a learned quality of character

- Just like holiness or love, God gives it to us by way of His Spirit at salvation…We have the responsibility to develop it through abiding in His word - 2 Pt. 1:5-8
- Temperance is seen in our willingness to surrender our own desires and preferences for the greater cause of reaching people - 1 Cor. 9:19-27
    - He equates this kind of living to an athlete. Discipline, training, and playing with PURPOSE and a GOAL, not out of control, willy nilly
    - Temperance is about being in control of your impulses, emotions, whims, etc. It relates to many other qualities we have looked at
    - Are you someone who is disciplined? Someone solid who can be counted on? Or are you prisoner to your every emotion, whim, and desire?

The Character Qualities of a Man or Woman of God

#27 - Holding fast the faithful word

Titus 1:9 - **Holding fast the faithful word** as he hath been taught, that he may be able by sound doctrine both to exhort and to convince the gainsayers.

Hold fast = "confidently holding the word of God, without wavering, even unto the end"

- 1 Sam. 3:19- As a young man, Samuel held onto every word of God dearly
  - Notice God was with him AND he grew. Why? Because he loved and dearly the word of God!

The man or woman of God must be doctrinally sound

- ✓ Proverbs 4:13- Refusing to let go the word of God (instruction) you've been given
- ✓ 2 Thess. 2:15 - Holding fast to what you have been taught from the word of God
- ✓ 2 Tim. 1:13-14 - Holding fast to the sound words committed to thee…
  - We must realize that someone is trying to take this truth out of our hands – 1 Tim. 4:1-2, 2 Tim. 4:1-4… Therefore we must be prepared to "earnestly contend for the faith" - Titus 1:9-11; Jude 3; 1 Pet. 3:15

A man or woman of God must learn how to use the Bible

- ✓ We must study the Bible so we will not be ashamed - 2 Tim. 2:15
- ✓ We must exercise in the word to become strong in the word - Heb. 5:11-14
  - We cannot stay "babies" in the word; we MUST grow up!
  - We may not know all we think we do; the devil has those who know much more than us, he is preparing and training up his false ministers too.
  - Our over confidence could make a mockery of the faith if we are not ready!
  - I'd watch videos of people we disagreed with and it would scare me to death to not have the answers needed, so I STUDIED! I studied what they believe, critics of what we believe, other faiths, etc. TO BE READY!

The Character Qualities of a Man or Woman of God

YOUNG WOMEN

"We all want clear, obvious, direct words from God on what he wants from us TODAY in our lives. For the next two weeks are are in luck. If you want to please God and know EXACTLY what his purpose is for you TODAY, we will be looking at his direct words to young men/women. God has a specific purpose/plan for how your life ought to look RIGHT NOW. If we listen and obey what he says, we can live in the purpose he has called us to"

Titus 2:4-5- That they may teach the young women to be sober, to love their husbands, to love their children, *To be* discreet, chaste, keepers at home, good, obedient to their own husbands, that the word of God be not blasphemed.

1 Timothy 5:14-15- I will therefore that the younger women marry, bear children, guide the house, give none occasion to the adversary to speak reproachfully. For some are already turned aside after Satan.

**NOTICE FIRST- the aged women are told to instruct the young women, NOT TITUS. There is a correct order to things here.

Make sure you are connecting to older women who you see living out the qualities that the Bible gives, not what YOU think a woman should be/do

Today the "young women" we will discuss are definitely right at/around the age of the young women in here today, however, due to culture differences of the time, they are assumed to be married and having kids already. Application can be made for preparing for this time in life, living these qualities with the authorities/opportunities given in your life now, and spiritually with Jesus Christ.

1. **Sober**- Thinking clearly; not "under the **influence**" of the world, flesh, devil; but the word of God
    a. We have looked at this quality many times already so we won't expound too much upon it. However, I believe God put this first to get our attention.
        i. He is saying: "LISTEN TO ME, don't be influenced by the world, or even the modern church, and all the feminist movement around the world; that is not how/what I made you for. It is a lie! Don't be under its influence!"
    b. Be open to the word of God today. Be under its influence and NOT under the influence of anything or anyone else. If you can't be "sober" on this, then you won't get the rest.
2. **Love their husbands and their children (in that order)**
    a. When connected with 1 Tim. 5:14-15, we see the reverence God gives to women who will be married, have kids, and guide/give for their home (live selfless)
        i. This is not the "popular, freeing, powerful, feminist" thing to do today, but God values it still.
    b. The enemy knows the power/influence of the home, that is why a MAJOR attack against the church in the last days is in the home (2 Tim. 3:1-6)
    c. To have a family like this and to love it (sacrifice/charity) is work and it is selfless. God values you not living for yourself, your desires, your dreams, your career, your…..(fill in the blank) BUT for a greater cause.
        i. God set the family order for a reason. To think your way is better or that usurping his order of things is better, is a lack of faith.
        ii. Loving your husband first, ultimately affects your kids the most!
            1. **Many studies have shown that kids who viewed their parents as "being in love" have a much higher rate of success in finance, education, less behavioral issues, etc.**
    d. Your influence on your husband and your kids and how that affects eternity is INCALCULABLE. But, it takes faith. It is not satisfying in the short term (instant gratification).
    e. Read these quotes from/about great missionaries and Christians through the years and what they say about this
3. **Discreet-** The literal sense is, separate, **reserved**, wary; prudent

a. The other 3 uses in the Bible of this word show the word associated with being "behind the scenes" or "unseen" (Gen. 41:33, 39; Mark 12:34)
b. We see this same posture for women talked about elsewhere in the Bible (1 Cor. 14:34-35; 1 Tim. 2:11-12)
    i. The fact that these verses cannot often even be talked about the correct biblical way in churches today is evidence of two things:
        1. The wresting (twisting) and mis-use of these verses for "lording" over women by insecure/ little men
        2. The feminist attitude and posture of many women today seeking to live how the world says they ought to, and not how the word of God commands they should
            a. Neither side would admit to these accusations, and both would give you "scripture" out of context in order to excuse their behavior, but these statements are still absolutely true.
    ii. It is a virtuous quality for a woman to have this posture. It shows humility, faith in God's word, self-control, and sober mindedness. They are influenced by God and nothing else.
        1. The point of these verses is not that women are less, should not ever talk, or are not needed; but rather that WHEN DONE THE PROPER WAY, they have the MOST influence possible doing it God's way, with the countenance and attitude God made them to have!
        2. No man likes a loud, contentious, busy-body woman. You are not made to like that. (Prov. 27:15; 21:9, 19; 9:13; 7:11)
            a. I have heard women pride themselves on being loud, stubborn, abrasive, having a "fighting spirit". This is not what you want to be associated with. Be what God says you should be, not anyone else.

4. **Chaste-** Pure; genuine; uncorrupt
    a. When we see this word used elsewhere in the Bible, it typically deals with **purity**
        i. Purity in sexuality- 2 Cor. 11:2
            1. Don't compromise on your purity sexually. God values it so much that he equates it to our faithfulness to him in our marriage to his son
            2. The world says that exploring your sexuality is freeing and the feminist movement teaches you that it is freeing/liberating; but God says that it is imprisoning/bondage to you (Prov. 5:22; 7:22-27; Rom. 6:16; 2 Pet. 2:19; John 8:34)
        ii. Purity in modesty- 1 Pet. 3:1-5
            1. Dressing modestly is directly linked by God in these verses to your submissive heart, meekness, and quietness.
            2. He is implying that to not be modest is connected to not being quiet, meek, submissive, AND VISE VERSA.
            3. Would anyone know you were a Christian by what you wear ALONE?
            4. Is your dress LOUD? Drawing unnecessary attention?
            5. This is why he connects the two. Wanting/desiring attention, whether in dress, speech, lifestyle, etc.. is not a godly attribute
5. **Keepers at home/Good/Obedient to Husbands**
    a. I linked these three together because they are similar to previous points and they speak to the same thing
    b. They all speak to a **submissive** attitude
        i. **Keepers at home**- Prov 7:11
            1. Notice where the strange woman's feet are; NOT AT HOME.
            2. This point is not just about being married and having kids (although this is a good thing to do) but about not living for yourself

a. The godly woman is not living HER LIFE, FOR HER, HER HAPPINESS, HER JOY, HER CAREER, ETC.. she is living for others (her family, disciples, church body, etc..)
   i. We see this all the time today with social media: me time, I need to find myself, my passion, my interests, my career, etc.. IT IS UNGODLY
b. If you are married/have kids or not, your life ought to be focused on helping and living for those around you/that you are close to (home); NOT YOURSELF

ii. **Good**- "Complete or sufficiently **perfect** in its kind; having the physical qualities best adapted to its design and use" (In the context of this passage and based on the law of first mention)- Gen. 1
   1. Doing what God made you to do, not what you think/desire to do in your flesh

iii. **Obedient to their own husbands**
   1. Submitting to the **authorities** in your life, as God placed them, the proper way (Eph 5:22)
      a. For married woman, to your OWN husbands, NOT all men everywhere
      b. For all: to government, to the ordained authorities in your life (pastor), to your bosses at work, teachers, etc..
      c. How you submit to the authorities in your life is how you submit to God
   2. Being able to submit to the authorities in your life as God has placed them, speaks volumes about your character and virtue as a woman
      a. God can use you in great ways, when you are willing to obey in these areas

6. That the word of God be not blasphemed/ That the name of God and his doctrine be not blasphemed

a. When these qualities are out of line and we choose to live based on how we think, the world dictates, or how we feel; then we give place for the word of God to be blasphemed! (2 Sam. 12:14; Rom. 2:24; 1 Tim. 6:1)
   i. When we subvert the word of God by thinking our way, our thinking, our feelings, are right and God is wrong; we give place for the enemies of God to blaspheme.
   ii. It is the same thing people say of those under them that they cannot control but they are supposed to (kids, workers, students, etc.. out of line)
      1. "Get your house/class/employees in order"
      2. "He can't even handle his own…"
         a. This is the enemies accusations of us when we don't submit to God's word

b. Today, let God be true and every man a liar. The Bible gives us CLEAR, NT passages on how we ought to live, specifically as young men/women. Don't listen to any other voices telling you anything outside of what God's word says on this. Submit and obey today and God will be glorified and not blasphemed.

The Character Qualities of a Man or Woman of God

YOUNG MEN

"We all want clear, obvious, direct words from God on what he wants from us TODAY in our lives. For the next two weeks are are in luck. If you want to please God and know EXACTLY what his purpose is for you TODAY, we will be looking at his direct words to young men/women. God has a specific purpose/plan for how your life ought to look RIGHT NOW. If we listen and obey what he says, we can live in the purpose he has called us to"

Titus 2:6-8- Young men likewise exhort to be sober minded. In all things shewing thyself a pattern of good works: in doctrine shewing uncorruptness, gravity, sincerity, Sound speech, that cannot be condemned; that he that is of the contrary part may be ashamed, having no evil thing to say of you.

1 John 2:13-14- I write unto you, fathers, because ye have known him that is from the beginning. I write unto you, **young men**, because ye have overcome the wicked one. I write unto you, little children, because ye have known the Father. I have written unto you, fathers, because ye have known him that is from the beginning. I have written unto you, **young men**, because ye are strong, and the word of God abideth in you, and ye have overcome the wicked one.

1. **Sober minded**- Thinking clearly; not "under the **influence**" of the world, flesh, devil; but the word of God
    a. We have looked at this quality many times already so we won't expound too much upon it. However, I believe God put this first to get our attention.
        i. He is saying: "LISTEN TO ME, don't be influenced by the world, or even the modern church, and all the feminist movement around the world; that is not how/what I made you for. It is a lie! Don't be under its influence!"
    b. Be open to the word of God today. Be under its influence and NOT under the influence of anything or anyone else. If you can't be "sober" on this, then you won't get the rest.
    c. Especially for young men, God emphasizes this point in his word
        i. Think clearly! Don't be out of control, under the influence of anything/anyone else, and submit to the word of God this morning. It should guide you, not your emotions/whims
2. **In all things shewing thyself a pattern of good works:-** A life that consistently shows a pattern of obedience and service to God
    a. Do you have this consistent pattern of good works? Are you someone that can be counted on, or are you showing signs of immaturity and always in a pattern of extreme highs and lows?
        i. Where does this pattern of good works come from?- 2 Tim. 3:16-17
        ii. What does this pattern of good works look like?- Neh.2:18; Titus 2:14
            1. It is associated with a burden for the work/people of God and with zealousness
3. **In doctrine shewing…**
    a. **Uncorruptness/Gravity-** You need to be solid in your **doctrine** and bible understanding, making sure you are not easily corrupted- 2 Cor. 2:17; 2 Tim. 1:13; Titus 2:1; 1:9
        i. You are at the place in life as a young man where God says you should be solid doctrinally
        ii. You should be able to not only stand in sound doctrine, but you should be able to defend the faith, defend the word of God, and convince others of the truth
        iii. We see this same idea in 1 Jn. 2:14- "the word of God abideth in you"
            1. God is assuming that young men are at the place where the word of God abides in them and they are able to stand against false doctrine and handle the word of God effectively
            2. Are you spending the time/study/effort needed to be at this place? Don't be fooled into thinking that you know more than you do, there are those out there who are on the other side who the

devil is using greatly for his cause and they don't stop studying, they commit their lives to it

b. **Sincerity-** To be **puffed** up with knowledge does you no good, charity edifieth. Are you sincere in your doctrine?- 2 Cor. 1:12; Philippians 1:9-10; Josh. 24:14 (1st mention)
   i. Doctrine is not meant for loveless, insincere knowledge to beat others down with, it is supposed to be paired with sincerity and love to effect others
   ii. God says that young men are expected to be at this place in their walk. Understanding it is not about just your knowledge, but charity
   iii. People don't care about how much you know, until they know how much you care.

c. **Sound speech that cannot be condemned-** Ultimately good doctrine should effect the way that you **speak**. When it is understood correctly and paired with sincerity, your speech will be sound and unable to be condemned- Eph. 4:29; 1 Cor. 15:33

4. **Ye are strong, and the word of God abideth in you, and ye have overcome the wicked one. -** God says that young men are expected to be in the place where they have overcome the devil BECAUSE they are strong/the word of God abideth in them- Matt. 13:19; Eph. 6:10-11; James 4:7
   a. The first mention of "wicked one" is in Matthew 13:19- From this we learn that one of the primary ways you can overcome the devil is by receiving and responding to the word of God whenever it is preached
      i. You are not going to overcome the devil by will power, strength, or your own means; the only way it can be done is with God! That is why it is so important that the word of God abides in you first!
      ii. You are only "strong" because the word of God abideth in you, and you can only "overcome the wicked one" because the word of God abideth in you
   b. Think about **David**- What made David great, the KEY to his life, was that from the very time he was a young man, until he was an old king, with power, wisdom, money, etc.. HE LOVED THE WORD OF GOD and IT ABODE IN HIM- Psalm 119:11, 97, 104, 128, 163, 159, 167, etc
      i. Think about David and Goliath; why did David win? Was it his strength? His cleverness? IT WAS HIS FAITH IN GOD/HIS WORD
      ii. If you want to have victories like this, you must make sure you are strong in the Word of God!! To overcome the "wicked one"
   c. Don't be so concerned with not making mistakes, as you are with not obeying the word of God and repenting when God speaks to you
      i. Life is not about "never messing up", read the bible and see if its true.
      ii. It is about who hears and responds to the word of God when it is preached! Who loves it above all else
   d. Have you seen victory in your life over the devil? Is it consistent?
      i. The answer to this is directly connected to your relationship to the word of God. Are you spending the time studying, loving, obeying it?